INVESTING & MARKETS (INDIA)

Market Data, Research & News Sources

Where to actually look — the source hierarchy from primary filings down to social noise, what is really on the NSE, BSE, SEBI and RBI websites, reading an annual report in 90 minutes and an earnings call transcript in 15, screeners and charting and fund research compared honestly, what flow data does and does not tell you, news ranked by incentive structure, how to spot a pump-and-dump or a paid promotion or an unregistered adviser, a deliberately small information diet with a daily/weekly/quarterly routine, a worked Python portfolio tracker, and a bookmark starter pack.

market research · india · nse · bse · sebi · rbi · screeners · annual report · earnings call · amfi · fii dii flows · financial news · pump and dump · investor education · information diet · portfolio tracker

Study Pack · Comprehensive reference & interview prep · ~88 min read · 19,275 words

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The Signal-to-Noise Problem

There has never been more financial information available to an Indian retail investor, and there has never been a worse ratio of useful information to confident noise. The constraint is no longer access. It is attention, and almost every commercial incentive in the market media chain is aligned against yours.

❌ **This is education about information sources, not financial advice**
Nothing in this guide recommends any security, scheme, fund, broker, platform, publication, newsletter, channel or adviser. Tools and publications are described so you can evaluate them yourself; **a mention here is a description, not an endorsement**, and none of them has been tested for accuracy by the author of this guide. **Past performance does not predict future returns. You can lose money, including your entire capital.** For advice specific to your circumstances, consult a **SEBI-registered Investment Adviser** and verify their registration number on the SEBI intermediary database at sebi.gov.in before paying anything. Nothing here is tax advice either — see the taxation guide, and have a chartered accountant review your actual return.

⚠ **URLs, features and pricing: as at early 2026 — verify**
Website structures, free-tier limits, subscription prices, data availability and regulatory portals all change. Where this guide is confident of a domain it gives the domain; where a specific path may have moved, it gives the domain root and describes the navigation instead. **Verify any URL, price or feature before relying on it.** Regulatory information in particular must be read from the regulator's own current page, not from a summary — including this one.

Why market media is built the way it is

Who	How they are paid	What that incentivises	What it does not incentivise
Business television	Advertising, sold against minutes watched	Urgency, conflict, a reason to keep watching, a view on everything at all times	Saying "nothing happened today that should change your portfolio"
Free news websites	Page views and ad impressions	Headlines that outperform the article, volume, speed over verification, listicles of stocks	Depth, correction, follow-up on past predictions
Brokers	Brokerage, float, cross-sell	Activity. Every research note, every alert, every "idea of the week" raises turnover.	"Do nothing for the next eleven months"
Fund houses	Expense ratio on assets under management	Gathering assets, launching products that are currently easy to sell	Telling you the category is expensive and you should wait
Distributors	Commission on what you buy	Products with higher commissions	Direct plans and index funds, which pay them nothing
Social media creators	Views, sponsorships, course sales, affiliate links, sometimes undisclosed payment for coverage	Confidence, novelty, strong claims, a reason to subscribe	Uncertainty, nuance, admitting a past call was wrong
Sell-side analysts	Employed by firms with banking and broking relationships	Maintaining access to management; distribution-friendly conclusions	Sell ratings. The distribution of ratings across the market is heavily skewed toward buy.
Unregistered tipsters	Subscription fees, or by holding the stock they are promoting	Whatever generates subscriptions or exit liquidity	Anything. These should not be in your information diet at all.

> **None of this requires anyone to be dishonest**
> Most people in financial media are competent and well-intentioned. The problem is structural: a channel that said "no action required" every day would have no viewers, and so no channel says it, and so the aggregate message reaching you is permanently biased toward action. You do not need to assume bad faith to conclude that the **default output of the system is more trading than is good for you**. The correct response is not cynicism — it is a deliberately constructed information diet.

The arithmetic of noise

TEXT

HOW MUCH OF WHAT YOU READ COULD POSSIBLY MATTER?

Suppose you hold four instruments: a broad index exposure, an international exposure, gold, and a short-duration debt fund. Your policy allocation is fixed and your IPS says you act only on a band breach or a life change.

In a typical year, how many pieces of information could legitimately change an action you take?

Band breach triggering a rebalance	0–2
A fund mandate or category change	0–1
A change in your own life	0–1
A change in tax law affecting you	0–2
A regulatory change affecting a holding's structure	0–1
TOTAL ACTIONABLE ITEMS PER YEAR	0–7

Now count the inputs if you follow the market normally:

Business news articles seen	~2,000
Social media posts about markets	~5,000
Push notifications from apps	~1,200
YouTube videos / reels	~ 400
WhatsApp group messages	~3,000
TOTAL INPUTS	~11,600

SIGNAL-TO-NOISE RATIO
7 / 11,600 = 0.06%

Put differently: 99.94% of what reaches you is, for your actual decisions, noise.

AND NOISE IS NOT NEUTRAL. Each input carries a small probability of provoking an action. If each has a 0.05% chance of causing an unplanned trade, 11,600 inputs produce about 6 unplanned trades a year. At a cost of brokerage, taxes and bad timing averaging – conservatively – 0.4% of portfolio value each, that is 2.4% a year. Which is roughly the entire equity risk premium over debt.

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THE CONCLUSION: reducing inputs is not
intellectual laziness. It is the single
highest-return information decision available,
and it is free.

Illustrative arithmetic to make a structural
point, not a measured result.
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0–7	15 min	60 min	<12
ACTIONABLE ITEMS/YEAR	DAILY ROUTINE	WEEKLY DEEP WORK	SOURCES WORTH KEEPING

What a good source looks like

IT IS PRIMARY, OR IT TELLS YOU WHERE THE PRIMARY IS

A report that links to the filing, the circular or the dataset lets you check. One that says "sources said" or "according to reports" does not. The presence of a citation is the cheapest quality signal available.

IT IS BORING

Regulatory filings, bhavcopy files, RBI bulletins and annual reports are boring because they are not trying to hold your attention. That is exactly why they are reliable. Excitement is a product feature, not an information feature.

IT PUBLISHES ITS MISTAKES

A source that corrects itself, keeps old predictions visible and occasionally says "I was wrong about this" is doing something structurally rare. A source whose archive contains only successes has curated it.

ITS INCENTIVES ARE VISIBLE

You know how it makes money, and that method does not depend on you transacting. A fee-only adviser, a subscription publication with no sponsorships, or a regulator all pass this test. A free tip channel does not.

IT DISTINGUISHES FACT FROM OPINION

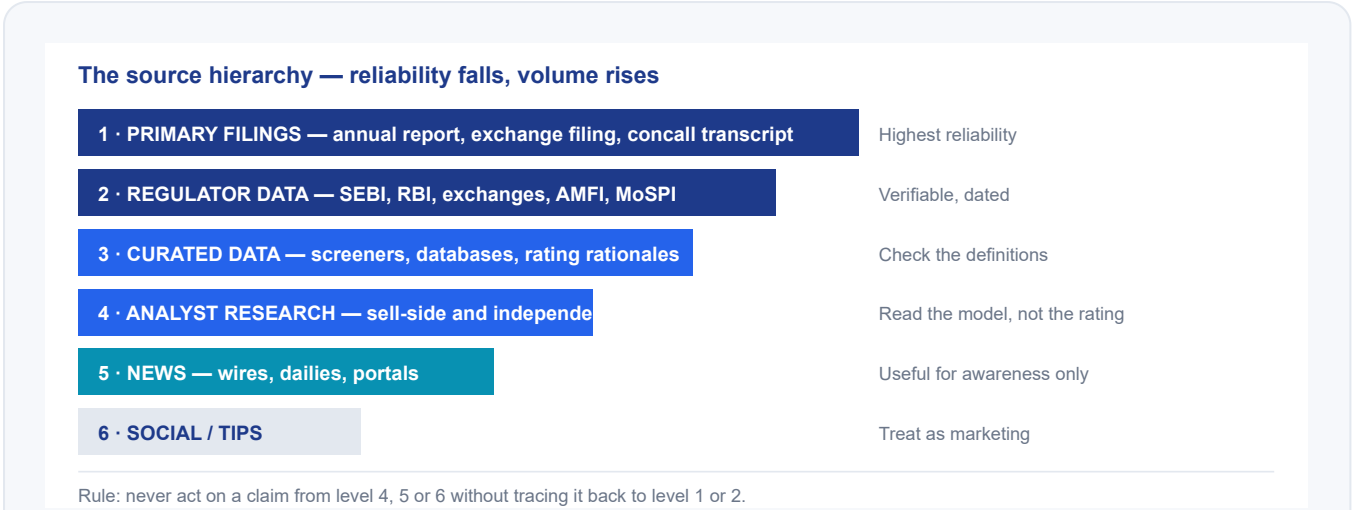
"Revenue grew 14% year on year" and "the stock looks attractive" are different statements. A source that blends them without signalling which is which is doing it deliberately.

IT IS SLOW

Almost nothing that matters to a long-horizon investor needs to be known within an hour. A weekly or monthly cadence filters out most of what turns out to be nothing, at no cost to you.

The Hierarchy of Sources

Every piece of market information sits somewhere on a chain that runs from the original document to the headline you eventually see. Each step down the chain adds interpretation, loses precision, and increases the chance of error. Knowing where a claim sits on that chain tells you how much weight it deserves — and more importantly, tells you where to go to check it.



The bar length is reliability, not volume — volume runs in the opposite direction. The lower you go, the more of it there is and the less of it matters.

The levels, in detail

Level	Examples	Strength	Weakness	Use it for
1. Primary filings	Annual report, quarterly results, investor presentation, earnings call transcript, DRHP, exchange announcements, scheme information documents	Comes from the entity itself, is legally consequential, and is the basis for everything downstream	Long; written to be compliant rather than clear; management framing is still framing	Everything that matters. If you are going to read one thing, read this.
2. Regulator and exchange data	SEBI circulars and orders, RBI policy statements and bulletins, NSE/BSE data, AMFI data, MoSPI releases, depository data	Authoritative, dated, usually free, and the same numbers everyone else is working from	Released on schedules; often in awkward formats; requires you to know what you are looking for	Rules, aggregates, flows, and settling any factual dispute
3. Curated data	Screeners, financial databases, credit rating rationales, index factsheets	Saves enormous time; standardises across companies	**Definitions vary between providers.** Two screeners can report different "ROE" for the same company. Errors propagate silently.	Shortlisting and comparison. Always verify a final candidate against the filing.
4. Analyst research	Sell-side reports, independent research, broker notes	Domain expertise, industry context, model structure you can learn from	Conflicts of interest; herding; ratings distribution skewed to buy; target prices that follow the price	Understanding the **drivers** of a business. Ignore the rating and the target price; read the assumptions.

5. News	Wire services, business dailies, portals, broadcast	Awareness that something happened; occasionally genuine investigative work	Speed over accuracy; headline-body mismatch; "sources said"; no follow-up when a story is wrong	Knowing an event occurred, then going to level 1 or 2 to find out what it actually was
6. Social and informal	Forums, X/Twitter, Telegram, WhatsApp, YouTube, Reddit	Occasionally surfaces a primary document faster than anyone; some genuinely expert individuals	No accountability, undisclosed positions, paid promotion, fabricated screenshots, survivorship in what gets shared	Discovering that a document exists. Nothing else.

✦ **The one-step-up rule**
Whenever you encounter a claim, ask: **what level is this, and what does the level above say?** A headline about a company's margin (level 5) should send you to the quarterly results (level 1). A screener's debt-to-equity figure (level 3) should be checked against the balance sheet (level 1) before you act on it. A tip (level 6) has no level above it that supports it, which is itself the answer. This single habit removes most information-related errors.

Exchange Primary Sources: NSE and BSE

The two exchange websites are, by a wide margin, the most underused free resources available to an Indian retail investor. Almost everything a news article reports about a listed company originated as a filing on one of them, usually hours earlier, in more detail, without interpretation.

Source	URL	What it is
National Stock Exchange	nseindia.com	The larger exchange by volume; corporate filings, market data, derivatives data, indices, circulars
BSE	bseindia.com	Corporate announcements, filings, market data; historically stronger coverage of smaller listed companies

What is actually on them

Resource	What it contains	Why it matters	How often to look
Corporate announcements	Every disclosure a listed company makes: results, board meetings, management changes, order wins, acquisitions, litigation, credit rating changes, clarifications to media reports	This is the source. News articles are derived from it. Reading it directly removes the interpretation layer and the delay.	For a holding: on any news. Otherwise quarterly.
Financial results	Quarterly and annual results in the prescribed format, with the auditor's report or limited review	The actual numbers, before anyone has characterised them as a "beat" or a "miss"	Each quarter for holdings
Shareholding pattern	Quarterly breakdown: promoter holding, promoter pledge, FII, DII, mutual funds, insurance, public, and the list of shareholders above 1%	**Promoter pledge is one of the highest-value free data points available.** A rising pledge percentage is a well-known stress signal. Changes in institutional holding show who is accumulating or exiting.	Quarterly
Insider trading disclosures	Disclosures under the SEBI (Prohibition of Insider Trading) Regulations by promoters, directors, designated persons and their immediate relatives	Shows who inside the company is buying or selling, and in what size. Not a trading signal by itself, but a sustained pattern of insider selling is information.	Monthly for holdings
Bulk and block deals	Bulk deals (trades above a threshold percentage of shares) and block deals (large negotiated trades in a separate window), disclosed with counterparty names	Shows large transactions and who was on each side, with a one-day lag	Weekly if you follow individual companies

FII / DII activity	Daily net buy and sell figures for foreign and domestic institutions in cash and derivative segments	Widely watched flow data. See the macro section for what it does and does not tell you.	Weekly at most
Option chain	Live and end-of-day open interest, volume, implied volatility and prices by strike and expiry	Essential if you trade derivatives; see the derivatives guide. Of limited use to a long-term investor.	Only if you trade
Index constituents and methodology	The exact composition and weights of each index, the methodology document, and the review calendar	If you own an index fund, this is **what you actually own.** The methodology document tells you the selection rules, rebalancing frequency and capping.	Annually, plus on index reconstitution
Circulars	Operational notices to members: settlement changes, holiday lists, margin changes, segment rule changes	Where operational market changes are announced first	Rarely; subscribe to a digest instead
Bhavcopy / historical data	Daily end-of-day price and volume files for every scrip, downloadable	The raw material for any backtest or tracker you build. See the automation section.	As needed
Securities in surveillance measures	Lists of securities under graded surveillance, additional surveillance or trade-to-trade restrictions	**A direct red flag list.** Securities placed under surveillance have attracted the exchange's attention for price or volume behaviour.	Before buying any small or illiquid company
Investor services and grievance	Complaint filing, arbitration, investor protection fund, defaulter member lists	What you use when a broker fails you — see the regulation section of the tax guide	Hopefully never

Navigation changes, structure does not

Both exchange sites are periodically redesigned and specific page URLs move. The reliable approach is to go to the domain root and look for the top-level sections — typically "Companies / Corporates", "Market Data", "Products", "Regulations / Circulars" and "Investor Services". Search by company name or symbol within the corporate filings section. Both sites also offer email alert subscriptions for announcements by company, which is the lowest-effort way to monitor a holding. **Both exchanges apply access controls and rate limits to automated requests; see the automation section.**

A worked example of using filings directly

TEXT

SCENARIO: a headline says "XYZ Ltd shares fall 8% on weak guidance"

LEVEL 5 (the headline) tells you:
- something happened
- a journalist characterised it as "weak guidance"
- the price moved

WHAT IT DOES NOT TELL YOU:
- what was actually said
- whether guidance was formally given at all
- whether the change relates to one segment or the whole business
- whether it is a demand issue, a cost issue, a one-off, or an accounting change
- what management said when asked about it

THE 12-MINUTE PROCESS TO FIND OUT

1. Go to the exchange corporate announcements page. Search the company name.
2. Open the announcement filed on the relevant date. It will be the results filing, the investor presentation, or a clarification.
3. Read the actual results table. Compare year-on-year AND quarter-on-quarter. Note whether the comparison period was unusual.
4. Open the investor presentation if filed. Look for the segment breakdown and the guidance slide if there is one.
5. Find the earnings call transcript (usually filed within a few days, also on the company's investor relations page). Search it for "guidance", "outlook", and the analyst questions near the end - the uncomfortable questions come last.
6. Check the shareholding pattern for the latest quarter. Any change in promoter pledge?
7. Check insider trading disclosures for the preceding months.

NOW you know what happened. The headline took 15 seconds and gave you an impression. The filings took 12 minutes and gave you the facts.

AND NOTE: for a diversified index investor,

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none of this changes any action. The exercise
is only worth doing for a direct holding in a
satellite sleeve — see the portfolio
construction guide on sizing that sleeve, and
the stock analysis guide on what to do with
the information once you have it.
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SEBI as a Source

Most investors encounter SEBI only as the body that issues rules they half-hear about on television. Its website is in fact one of the richest primary sources available — regulations in their consolidated form, enforcement orders that read like case studies in exactly how retail investors get defrauded, consultation papers that tell you what is coming, and the intermediary database that lets you verify anyone claiming to be registered.

Resource	What it is	Why an investor should care
Legal framework / regulations	The actual text of each set of regulations — LODR for listed company disclosure, Mutual Fund Regulations, Investment Adviser Regulations, Research Analyst Regulations, PIT Regulations on insider trading, SAST on takeovers, ICDR on issues	When you want to know what a company or an adviser is actually required to do, this is the only authoritative answer. Summaries are routinely wrong on detail.
Circulars and master circulars	Operational instructions; master circulars consolidate scattered directions by subject	Master circulars are the efficient way in — one document per subject area rather than a decade of amendments
Enforcement orders	Adjudication and quasi-judicial orders against individuals and entities, with full findings of fact	**The most instructive free reading available on how frauds actually work.** Pump-and-dump mechanics, front-running, mis-selling, unregistered advisory operations and fund diversion are all documented in detail, with the methods described.
Consultation papers	Proposed regulatory changes put out for public comment before being made	Tells you what rules are coming, months in advance. Anyone genuinely following the market reads these rather than reacting to the eventual circular.
Intermediary database	Searchable list of registered brokers, investment advisers, research analysts, portfolio managers, mutual funds, merchant bankers and others	**Use this before paying anyone.** See the verification checklist below.
Investor education materials	Booklets, FAQs, caution notices, investor awareness content, and the investor website	Free, accurate, and written with no product to sell — a combination essentially unavailable elsewhere
SCORES	The complaints redressal portal for grievances against registered intermediaries and listed companies	The escalation route when an entity does not respond. See the tax and regulation guide for the full escalation chain.
Research and statistics	SEBI's own studies and bulletins, including periodic analyses of retail	SEBI's studies of individual trader outcomes in the equity derivatives segment are among the most important

	participation and outcomes in specific segments	things an aspiring derivatives trader could read. See the trading risk guide. **Read the latest study directly at sebi.gov.in rather than any summary of it.**
Caution lists and press releases	Warnings about unregistered entities, fraudulent schemes and impersonation	Check before engaging with any entity you found through social media

Verifying an intermediary — the exact procedure

1. **Get the claimed registration number**
   Registered entities must display it. If someone cannot produce one immediately, stop there.

2. **Search the SEBI intermediary database by name**
   Go to sebi.gov.in and find the intermediaries section. Search the exact entity name — not the brand name used in marketing, which is often different from the registered name.

3. **Match the number, the name and the category**
   All three. A number that exists but belongs to a different entity is the oldest trick in this space.

4. **Check the category is the right one for what they are doing**
   A **research analyst** registration permits issuing research; it does not permit personalised investment advice. An **investment adviser** registration does. A **distributor** (AMFI ARN) can sell mutual funds on commission but is not an adviser. These are different permissions and are routinely conflated in marketing.

5. **Search the entity name in SEBI's orders and press releases**
   Enforcement history is public. So are caution notices.

6. **Check how they want to be paid**
   A registered investment adviser is subject to rules on fee structures and on what they may and may not do. **Verify the current fee rules.** Payment into a personal account, profit-sharing arrangements, or a request for your trading credentials are all disqualifying.

7 **Be suspicious of any assured return**

Guaranteed returns in securities are a regulatory red flag in themselves, and an entity promising them is either unregistered or non-compliant.

✕ **If they are not registered, you have no recourse**

The investor protection fund, SCORES, SMART ODR and exchange arbitration all exist for **registered** intermediaries. An unregistered "advisory service" operating through a Telegram channel sits entirely outside that perimeter. If the money goes, the route is a police complaint and a civil suit, not a regulatory remedy. **Verification takes four minutes and is the single highest-value habit in this entire guide.**

RBI, MCA, AMFI and Government Statistics

Beyond the securities regulator sit the sources that describe the economy the companies operate in, the legal entities behind them, and the fund industry that packages them. Each is free, each is authoritative, and each is read by almost no retail investor.

Reserve Bank of India

Resource	What it is	How to use it
Monetary policy statements and resolutions	The Monetary Policy Committee's decision, the statement, the resolution and the minutes published later	The policy rate decision is the headline; the **statement and minutes** are where the reasoning is. Read the minutes to see the range of views on the committee, which is more informative than the single number.
Monetary Policy Report	Twice-yearly assessment of inflation, growth and the outlook	The most careful public analysis of the Indian macro position available free
RBI Bulletin	Monthly, with articles, speeches and a large statistical annexure	The "State of the Economy" article each month is a dense, readable summary. Genuinely worth 20 minutes a month.
Database on the Indian Economy (DBIE)	A queryable statistical database covering money, banking, prices, trade, external sector, government finances and more, with long historical series	Where to go when you want the actual number rather than a journalist's version. Downloadable series for any analysis you want to do yourself.
Financial Stability Report	Half-yearly assessment of systemic risk, bank asset quality, stress tests	The honest institutional view of where the financial system's weaknesses are
Weekly Statistical Supplement	Money supply, foreign exchange reserves, bank credit and deposit growth	Foreign exchange reserves and credit growth are among the few weekly macro numbers that mean anything
Master directions and circulars	Rules for banks, NBFCs, payment systems and FEMA matters including the **Liberalised Remittance Scheme**	The authoritative source for LRS limits and conditions — see the tax guide
Unclaimed deposits facility	A centralised search for unclaimed bank deposits	Worth one search in your own name and your parents' names. **Verify the current name and access route.**

All of the above are at rbi.org.in. The site's structure is stable but dense; the top-level navigation separates Publications, Statistics, Notifications and Regulatory Reporting. Policy dates are published in advance in a calendar — put them in your own calendar rather than discovering them from a headline.

Ministry of Corporate Affairs

Resource	What it is	Use
Company master data	Registration details, status, directors, registered office for every company registered in India — listed or not	Checking that an entity you are dealing with exists, is active, and has the directors it claims
Director identification (DIN) search	Which companies a given individual is a director of	Mapping group structures and spotting an individual associated with several failed entities
Filed documents	Annual returns and financial statements filed by companies, available for a fee	The only route to financials for an **unlisted** company — a supplier, a customer, or a private company you are being invited to invest in
Investor Education and Protection Fund (IEPF)	Unclaimed dividends and shares transferred after the statutory period, and the reclaim process	Search in your own and family names — see the tax guide on unclaimed assets

At mca.gov.in. Some services require registration and some documents carry a fee. The IEPF has its own portal linked from the MCA site.

AMFI

Resource	What it is	Use
Daily NAV data	NAV for every scheme of every member AMC, downloadable	The authoritative NAV source; also the input for any tracker you build
Industry AUM and flow data	Monthly assets under management by category, net inflows and outflows, folio counts, SIP contribution totals	**Category flow data is a useful sentiment indicator.** Record inflows into a category usually coincide with that category being expensive. Read it as a contrarian temperature check, not a signal.
Scheme categorisation	The SEBI-mandated category definitions and which scheme sits in which category	Checking that a fund is actually what its name suggests
ARN search	Registered mutual fund distributor details	Verifying a distributor; note that a distributor is **not** an adviser
Investor awareness material	Educational content, including on scheme categories and risk	Free and accurate

At amfiindia.com. See the mutual funds guide for what to do with scheme categorisation.

Government statistics

Source	What it publishes	Release cadence
MoSPI (Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation)	GDP and national accounts, **CPI inflation**, Index of Industrial Production, periodic labour force survey	CPI and IIP monthly; GDP quarterly with annual revisions
Office of the Economic Adviser (under DPIIT)	**Wholesale Price Index**	Monthly
DPIIT	FDI statistics, industrial policy	Quarterly
Ministry of Finance	Union Budget documents, Economic Survey, monthly accounts, fiscal deficit data	Budget annually; Economic Survey alongside it
Department of Commerce	Merchandise and services trade data	Monthly
GST portal / CBIC	Monthly GST collection figures	Monthly, early in the month

> **Read the release, not the headline, for inflation and GDP**
> CPI and GDP headlines are routinely reported without the base effect, the revision to the prior period, or the composition. A monthly CPI print of 5.2% against 4.8% is not necessarily "inflation rising" if the prior-year base was unusually low. The MoSPI press release itself gives the sub-indices and the base-effect explanation in two pages. **The Economic Survey, published alongside the Union Budget, is the single most useful free document on the Indian economy published each year** — dense, readable, and almost entirely unread by retail investors.

Company Sources: Reading an Annual Report in 90 Minutes

The annual report is the single most information-dense document a listed company produces, and it is free, filed with both exchanges, and posted on the company's own website. It is also three hundred pages long, which is why almost nobody reads it. There is a reading order that extracts most of the value in about ninety minutes.

⚠ **Only worth doing for a direct holding**

If your equity exposure is through index funds, reading annual reports is intellectually interesting and operationally pointless — you own the index, not the company, and you cannot act on what you find. This section is for the capped direct-equity satellite sleeve described in the portfolio construction guide, used alongside the methods in the stock analysis guide.

The 90-minute reading order

1. **Auditor's report — 10 minutes. Read this first.**
   Look for the opinion type (unmodified, qualified, adverse, disclaimer), the **Key Audit Matters**, any **emphasis of matter**, and the **CARO** annexure. A qualified opinion, a going-concern emphasis, or an auditor who resigned mid-year ends the exercise. Also check: **who is the auditor, and how long have they been there?** A recent auditor change with no clear reason is worth understanding.

2. **Cash flow statement — 10 minutes**
   Operating cash flow versus reported profit, over five years if the report shows them. A company reporting growing profit with flat or negative operating cash flow is telling you something the income statement is not. Then look at investing cash flow (is capital expenditure consistent with the growth story?) and financing cash flow (is growth funded by debt or equity issuance?).

3. **Notes to accounts — 25 minutes, selectively**
   Not all of them. Go to: **related party transactions** (who else is being paid, and how much); **contingent liabilities** (the obligations not on the balance sheet); **borrowings** (amounts, maturities, rates, covenants, security); **revenue recognition policy**; **receivables ageing**; **inventory**; and any note the Key Audit Matters pointed to.

4

Management discussion and analysis — 15 minutes

Read it for what it **omits**. If a segment that was discussed extensively last year is barely mentioned this year, find out why. Compare the language on outlook with last year's — year-on-year comparison of the MD&A is more informative than reading one in isolation.

5

Corporate governance report and director details — 10 minutes

Board composition, independent director tenure and attendance, audit committee composition, **related party approval processes**, and remuneration of directors and key management relative to profit.

6

Shareholding and promoter pledge — 5 minutes

In the report and, more currently, on the exchange site. Pledge percentage and its trend.

7

Segment reporting — 10 minutes

Where the revenue and profit actually come from. Many companies are one profitable segment carrying several loss-making ones, which the consolidated numbers hide.

8

Chairman's and CEO letters — 5 minutes

Read last year's first, then this year's. Did they do what they said they would? A management that sets out specific commitments and then reports against them honestly is rare and valuable.

✦ **The highest-value trick: read two years at once**

Download this year's and last year's annual report. Compare the same sections side by side — the accounting policies, the MD&A, the segment disclosure, the related party list, the contingent liabilities, the risk factors. **Changes in language are more informative than the language itself.** A risk factor that moves up the list, a policy that changes, a related party that appears or disappears, a segment that stops being broken out — these are the things that do not make it into any news article.

What to look for, and what it may mean

Observation	Possible benign explanation	Possible warning
Operating cash flow consistently below net profit	Rapid growth consuming working capital	Revenue recognised that is not being collected; aggressive accounting
Receivables growing much faster than revenue	A change in customer mix or credit terms	Channel stuffing; collection problems; related-party sales
Rising promoter pledge	Promoter funding a personal or group requirement	Group-level stress; risk of forced sale if the price falls
Large and growing "other income"	Genuine treasury income on a cash pile	Core business weakness being masked
Frequent change of auditor or CFO	Normal rotation, which is now mandated in some cases	Disagreement over accounting treatment
Extensive related party transactions	Normal group structure with shared services	Value leaving the listed entity to privately held entities
Large contingent liabilities relative to net worth	Routine tax disputes, which are extremely common in India	An obligation that could crystallise and exceed equity
Capital raised repeatedly without corresponding growth	A genuinely capital-intensive expansion phase	Cash burn; dilution without return
Segment disclosure that becomes less granular	A genuine reorganisation	Hiding a deteriorating segment
Accounting policy change with a restated prior period	A new accounting standard applying to everyone	A company-specific change that flatters the current period

✕ **An observation is a question, not a conclusion**

Every item in the right-hand column above has an innocent explanation in most cases. The purpose of noticing it is to **ask the question** — in the earnings call transcript, in last year's report, in the notes. Treating a single red flag as proof of fraud is as wrong as ignoring it. The pattern that matters is several flags together, combined with management that does not answer the question when asked.

Quarterly Results, Presentations and Earnings Calls

The earnings call transcript is, without close competition, the highest-value free resource available on a listed Indian company. It is the only document in which management is asked questions they did not choose, by people who have read the numbers, with the answers on the record.

The quarterly document set

Document	What it is	Where	Value
Results filing	The prescribed financial results format, with a limited review or audit report	Exchange corporate announcements; company investor relations page	The numbers themselves. Always read the standalone *and* consolidated columns.
Press release	Management's characterisation of the quarter	Same	Low — this is marketing. Useful only for the specific figures management chooses to highlight, which tells you what they want you to look at.
Investor presentation	Slides with segment data, operating metrics, guidance, strategy	Same	**High.** Often contains operational metrics not in the financial statements — volumes, utilisation, realisation, store counts, order book.
Earnings call audio	Live or recorded call with analysts	Company IR page; some filed with exchanges	High, but slow to consume
Earnings call transcript	Verbatim text of the above, usually filed within a few days	Exchange filings and company IR page	**Highest.** Searchable, fast to read, contains the questions management did not want.
Business update	Pre-results operational disclosure, common in some sectors	Exchange filings	Early signal on volumes or collections

How to read a transcript in 15 minutes

1. **Skip the opening remarks entirely on the first pass**
   They are a scripted reading of the press release. Come back if you have time.

2. **Go straight to the Q&A**
   This is where the information is. The transcript will mark it clearly.

3. **Read the last three questions first**
   Call time is finite and operators take questions in order of queue position, but the most pointed questions — often from analysts who are sceptical — frequently come late, when the comfortable ones have been exhausted.

4. **Search for specific words**
   "Guidance", "outlook", "margin", "pricing", "competition", "working capital", "debt", "capex", "one-off", "exceptional". Each search takes seconds and lands you on the substantive exchanges.

5. **Note the questions that were not answered**
   "We will come back to you offline", "we do not break that out", "directionally it is in line" — these are non-answers. One is normal. A pattern of them on the same topic across consecutive quarters is information.

6. **Compare with the previous two quarters' transcripts**
   Did management say something last quarter that this quarter's numbers contradict? Has the explanation for a weak segment changed three times in three quarters? This is the single highest-value comparison available and nobody does it.

7. **Note who is asking**
   The same analysts appear repeatedly. Over a few quarters you will identify the ones who ask substantive questions, and you can read their questions first.

TEXT

```
A TRANSCRIPT READING TEMPLATE
(for a direct holding; 15 minutes per quarter)

COMPANY: _____________  QUARTER: ________
DATE READ: ___________

 1. WHAT DID MANAGEMENT SAY WOULD HAPPEN LAST
    QUARTER?
    ____________________________________________
    DID IT HAPPEN?   yes / no / partly

 2. THREE THINGS I LEARNED THAT ARE NOT IN THE
    PRESS RELEASE
    a. _________________________________________
    b. _________________________________________
    c. _________________________________________

 3. QUESTIONS ASKED THAT WERE NOT ANSWERED
    ____________________________________________
    Is this the first quarter this has happened?
    yes / no

 4. ANY CHANGE IN THE EXPLANATION FOR A
    PERSISTENT ISSUE?
    ____________________________________________

 5. GUIDANCE OR OUTLOOK STATED (exact words)
    ____________________________________________

 6. DOES ANY OF THIS TOUCH MY WRITTEN THESIS?
    (see the thesis note template in the
     portfolio construction guide)
    - thesis intact                      [ ]
    - thesis weakened but not broken     [ ]
    - a specific "what would make me wrong"
      condition has been triggered       [ ]

 7. ACTION
    - none (the default)                 [ ]
    - reduce / exit per the thesis note  [ ]
    - add, within position limits        [ ]

NOTE: "none" should be the answer the large
majority of the time. If you are finding a
reason to act every quarter, the problem is
the process, not the company.
```

✦ **Where to find transcripts**

The company's own investor relations page is the primary location, and listed companies are generally required to make earnings call recordings and transcripts available — **verify the current requirement under the SEBI LODR Regulations at sebi.gov.in**. Transcripts are also commonly filed with the exchanges under corporate announcements. Several screeners and data platforms aggregate them, which is more convenient; the filing is the authoritative version.

Exchange Filings and the Material Event Rules

Listed companies in India are required to disclose material events to the exchanges within specified timelines. Understanding what must be disclosed, and how fast, tells you what you can expect to find in the filings — and tells you when a "news report" about an undisclosed development should be treated with suspicion.

Element	Position (verify at sebi.gov.in)
Governing framework	**SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015** — "LODR" — particularly Regulation 30 and Schedule III
Deemed material events	A list of events that are material by their nature and must always be disclosed — including acquisitions, scheme of arrangement, winding up, changes in key managerial personnel, auditor resignation, fraud by or against the company, and others
Events material on a threshold test	Events material based on quantitative criteria tied to turnover, net worth or profit, with the company's own materiality policy applying
Timelines	Prescribed timelines from the occurrence of the event or from the board decision, which were **tightened** in recent amendments. **Verify the current timelines.**
Market rumour verification	An obligation on specified listed entities to confirm, deny or clarify market rumours reported in mainstream media that cause material price movement. **Verify the current applicability, thresholds and the framework for the "unaffected price" concept.**
Where filed	Exchange announcement portals, and on the company's own website

> **The practical consequence**
> If a genuinely material development has occurred, there should be a filing. A story circulating on social media about a large order, an acquisition or a regulatory action, with **no corresponding exchange filing and no clarification**, is either not material, not true, or both. The rumour-verification framework means that a sustained unexplained price move accompanied by media reports should produce a company response. **Checking the exchange filings before acting on a story is a thirty-second test that defeats most market rumours.**

Credit Rating Rationales and DRHPs

Two underused document types give you a third-party analytical view that is free, detailed, and written by people with access you do not have.

Credit rating rationales

Aspect	Detail
What they are	When a SEBI-registered credit rating agency rates a company's debt instruments or bank facilities, it publishes a **rationale** explaining the rating, the key rating drivers, the liquidity position, and — most usefully — the **rating sensitivities**: the specific conditions that would cause an upgrade or a downgrade
Where	On each rating agency's own website, free and searchable by company name. Companies also file rating changes with the exchanges as a disclosable event.
Why they are valuable	**The rating sensitivities section is effectively a pre-written list of what to monitor.** It states, in numbers, the leverage and coverage levels at which the view changes. That is a better-defined thesis framework than most equity research provides.
Also valuable	The liquidity assessment, the description of group structure and support, and the discussion of contingent liabilities — often more candid than the annual report's MD&A
Limitations	Ratings are **paid for by the issuer**, which is a structural conflict. Ratings have lagged deterioration in notable past cases in India. A rating is an opinion on **credit**, not on equity value — a safe bond can sit under a terrible equity story.
What a withdrawal means	A rating "withdrawn" or moved to "issuer not cooperating" is itself information. Agencies publish the reason; non-cooperation is rarely a good sign.

DRHPs and RHPs

Aspect	Detail
What they are	The **Draft Red Herring Prospectus** filed with SEBI before an initial public offering, and the **Red Herring Prospectus** filed before the issue opens. Hundreds of pages, prepared under legal liability.
Where	SEBI's website publishes filed DRHPs; the merchant bankers and exchanges also host them
Why they are valuable even if you never buy an IPO	**The industry overview section** is typically a commissioned report on the whole sector — market size, growth, competitive structure, margins of listed and unlisted players. It is the best free industry primer available, and it covers *competitors*, not just the issuer. **The risk factors section** is a legally-drafted list of everything that could go wrong, written by lawyers who are liable for omissions.
How to read one quickly	Industry overview (20 min) → risk factors, especially the company-specific ones at the top (15 min) → financial statements and the restated summary (15 min) → **objects of the issue**: is the money going into the business or to selling shareholders? (5 min) → related party transactions (5 min) → promoter background and litigation (5 min)
The structural caution	A DRHP is a selling document prepared when the issuer has chosen the moment. Historical financials are presented in the most favourable permitted manner. **The risk factors are the honest section precisely because they are the one part nobody is incentivised to understate.**
Offer for sale versus fresh issue	Check how much of the issue is a **fresh issue** (money into the company) versus an **offer for sale** (money to existing shareholders). A large offer for sale is not disqualifying but it changes what you are participating in.

⚠ **Nothing here is a view on IPOs**

This section describes the documents, not the merits of participating in any offering. IPO investing has its own characteristics — information asymmetry, issuer-chosen timing, limited operating history as a listed entity, and lock-in expiries — that are discussed in the Indian stock market guide. **No IPO, past or forthcoming, is recommended anywhere in this guide.**

Screeners and Data Tools, Compared

A screener turns thousands of companies into a shortlist in seconds. That is genuinely valuable and genuinely dangerous: the shortlist feels like analysis when it is only a filter, and the underlying numbers are a vendor's interpretation of a filing, not the filing itself. Use them to narrow, never to decide.

Descriptions, not endorsements

The tools below are described so you can evaluate them. **None is recommended, none has been tested for data accuracy by this guide, and features and pricing change constantly.** Several are operated by or affiliated with brokers and other intermediaries, which is a commercial relationship you should factor in. Check the current free-tier limits and subscription cost yourself before committing. Where a tool offers "recommendations", "scores" or "ratings", treat those as the vendor's opinion — and note that providing personalised investment advice requires SEBI registration as an investment adviser. **Verify the registration status of any platform offering what looks like advice.**

Tool	URL	What it is actually good for	Where it is weak	Cost character
Screener.in	screener.in	Fast, clean fundamental screening on Indian listed companies with ten years of standardised financials; custom ratio formulas; saved screens; a usable company page that puts the P&L, balance sheet, cash flow and ratios on one screen; links to filings and concall documents	Fundamentals only — no real charting; standardisation can obscure company-specific accounting; consolidated versus standalone selection matters and is easy to get wrong	Substantial free tier; paid tier for additional features
Trendlyne	trendlyne.com	Aggregated analyst estimates and target prices, result calendars, shareholding change tracking, insider and bulk deal feeds, derivative data, alert configuration	Heavy on scores and proprietary indicators whose methodology is not always transparent; a lot of surface area invites browsing rather than working	Free tier plus several paid tiers
Tickertape	tickertape.in	Clean interface, portfolio import and analysis, readable company pages, screening with a gentle learning curve; useful for someone starting out	Scores and "checklists" compress a lot of judgement into a single number; affiliated with a broker	Free tier plus subscription

Chartink	chartink.com	**Technical** screening — scanning the whole market for price and indicator conditions, with a scan builder and backtest facility on those scans	Purely technical; no fundamental data; backtests on technical scans are extremely easy to over-fit. See the trading risk guide on why most technical backtests do not survive contact with costs.	Free tier plus subscription
StockEdge	stockedge.com	Mobile-first analytics, scans combining fundamental and technical criteria, delivery volume data, sector and thematic groupings, FII/DII and derivative dashboards	App-centric; some data behind higher tiers; large number of "edges" can substitute for thinking	Free tier plus subscription
Simply Wall St	simplywall.st	Visual company summaries, coverage of global as well as Indian equities, automated valuation snapshots that are useful for orientation on an unfamiliar market	Automated valuations are formulaic and should never be used as a conclusion; global coverage means less India-specific depth	Limited free tier; subscription
Finology (Ticker)	finology.in	Company pages aimed at beginners, with educational framing alongside the data	Oriented to learning rather than deep research	Free tier plus subscription

Tijori Finance	tijorifinance.com	**Segment-level and operational data** — capacity, volumes, subsidiary detail, business breakdowns, and mapping of listed proxies to themes. This is data that is genuinely hard to assemble yourself.	Paid; coverage depth varies by company	Subscription
Exchange sites	nseindia.com, bseindia.com	Primary filings, shareholding, insider data, index constituents, bhavcopy — the source for everything above	Not designed for screening or comparison	Free

How to use a screener without being misled

1. **Check the definition of every ratio you filter on**
   "ROCE" can be computed with or without cash, with average or closing capital employed, with or without other income. Two providers will give different numbers for the same company and both will be defensible.
   Read the provider's definition before filtering on it.

2. **Decide consolidated or standalone deliberately**
   For a company with significant subsidiaries these are completely different businesses. Screening on standalone numbers for a holding company produces nonsense.

3. **Beware survivorship**
   A screener shows companies that are currently listed. Companies that were delisted, suspended or went to insolvency have left the universe. Any "this screen would have returned X%" claim built on current constituents is overstated by an unknown margin.

4. **Do not over-fit the filter**
   A screen with nine conditions returning four companies has not found four good companies; it has found four companies that happen to satisfy nine arbitrary thresholds. Three or four conditions with a clear economic rationale is usually the limit of what means anything.

5

Treat the output as a reading list

The screen's job is to produce ten names to read about, not ten names to buy. The work starts after the screen.

6

Verify the final candidates against the filing

Before any position, check the key numbers in the annual report. Data errors in aggregators are not rare, particularly after corporate actions, restatements and accounting standard changes.

7

Exclude the surveillance list

Cross-check candidates against the exchanges' graded surveillance and trade-to-trade lists before going further.

TEXT

```
WHAT A SCREEN CAN AND CANNOT TELL YOU

A SCREEN CAN TELL YOU
  - which companies currently satisfy a set of
    numeric conditions
  - how a number compares across a peer set
  - that something has changed since last
    quarter
  - where to spend your reading time

A SCREEN CANNOT TELL YOU
  - whether the accounting is honest
  - whether the business will still exist in
    ten years
  - whether the promoter is trustworthy
  - what the price already assumes
  - whether the last three years of growth
    were a cycle or a trend
  - whether the ratio you filtered on means
    what you think it means for THIS industry

A WORKED CAUTION

  Screen: "ROE above 20%, debt-to-equity below
  0.3, five-year profit growth above 15%."

  This is a reasonable quality screen. It will
  also systematically return:
   - companies at the top of a cyclical peak,
     where trailing numbers flatter
   - companies whose ROE is high because the
     equity base is small after years of
     dividends or buybacks
   - companies where "profit" includes a
     significant one-off
   - companies in industries where low capital
     intensity makes 20% ROE unremarkable
   - companies whose growth came entirely from
     acquisitions funded off-balance-sheet

  And it will systematically EXCLUDE:
   - good businesses in a temporary bad patch
   - capital-intensive businesses where 15% ROE
     is excellent for the industry
   - companies that recently raised equity,
     depressing ROE for a year

  The screen is not wrong. It is a filter, and
```

```
every filter has both error types. Knowing
which errors YOUR filter makes is the skill.
```

Charting Platforms

Charting tools are excellent at what they do and widely used for things they cannot do. For a long-term investor the honest use case is narrow: seeing long-run price history, comparing instruments on a normalised basis, and checking the premium or discount of an exchange-traded product.

Platform	URL	Free tier gives you	Notes
TradingView	tradingview.com	Charting across Indian and global instruments, a large indicator library, a scripting language for custom indicators and strategies, watchlists, alerts (limited in number on the free tier), and a public ideas feed	The free tier limits indicators per chart, saved layouts, alert count and some data granularity. Real-time Indian exchange data typically requires a paid data subscription in addition to the platform tier. **Verify current tier limits and data pricing.** The social "ideas" feed is user-generated content with no verification — treat it as level 6 on the hierarchy.
Broker platforms	Varies by broker	Charting integrated with your actual positions and orders, usually with real-time data on the instruments you can trade, basic to intermediate indicator sets	Adequate for most purposes and already included in what you pay. The integration with order placement is convenient and is also the point — it lowers the friction to trade.
Exchange sites	nseindia.com, bseindia.com	Basic charting plus downloadable historical data	The authoritative price history, in a format you can analyse yourself
Chartink	chartink.com	Technical screening across the market rather than charting a single instrument	Complements rather than replaces a charting platform

⚠ **An honest word on technical analysis**

The evidence on whether technical patterns predict returns net of costs is contested and considerably weaker than its popularity suggests. This guide does not take a position on whether it works for anyone; it notes that the burden of proof sits with the method, and that **transaction costs and taxes, which are certain, must be overcome by an edge that is not** — see the cost stack in the tax guide and the honest treatment in the trading strategy and risk guide. For the long-term investor described in the portfolio construction guide, charting software is a visualisation tool, not a decision tool.

Legitimate uses of a chart for a long-term investor

- ☐ Seeing the **full drawdown history** of an index or asset class over 20 years, which makes the model-allocation drawdown tables concrete.
- ☐ Comparing two instruments on a **percentage-normalised** basis to see how differently they behave — a quick visual correlation check.
- ☐ Checking the **premium or discount** of an exchange-traded fund to its indicative value before placing an order, especially in thinly traded products.
- ☐ Checking **liquidity** — traded volume and the spread — before dealing in anything outside the large-cap universe.
- ☐ Setting a small number of **price alerts** that correspond to a pre-written rule in your IPS, such as a drawdown level at which you deploy idle cash.
- ☐ Looking at a long-run **currency** chart when sizing an international allocation.

Mutual Fund Research

Fund research in India has unusually good free infrastructure: the regulator mandates disclosure, the industry body publishes the data, two registrars cover almost the entire market, and an independent scorecard measures active managers against their benchmarks. The main risk is not lack of data — it is being drawn into star ratings and recent-return league tables.

Source	URL	What it gives you	Caution
AMFI	amfiindia.com	Daily NAV for every scheme, monthly industry AUM and flows by category, SIP contribution totals, scheme categorisation, ARN distributor search	Industry-level data; no scheme analysis
Value Research	valueresearchonline.com	Scheme-level data, category comparisons, portfolio holdings and overlap, rolling returns, risk measures, long-running analysis	Star ratings are backward-looking by construction. The data is the value; the ratings are an opinion.
Morningstar India	morningstar.in	Scheme data, qualitative analyst coverage on some funds, category definitions, portfolio analysis	Same caution on ratings; coverage depth varies
MF Central	mfcentral.com	A single view of **your own** mutual fund holdings across both registrars, with service requests — nomination updates, KYC, consolidated statements	A holdings and servicing platform, not a research tool
CAMS	camsonline.com	Consolidated account statements and **capital gains statements** for schemes it services; mailback services by PAN	Covers only AMCs it serves; pair with the other registrar
KFintech	kfintech.com	The same for the AMCs it services	As above
SPIVA India scorecard	spglobal.com/spdji	The percentage of actively managed funds in each category that underperformed their benchmark over 1, 3, 5 and 10 years, **corrected**	Benchmark choice matters and is stated in the methodology. Read the methodology, not just

		for survivorship, published periodically	the headline percentage.
AMC websites and scheme documents	Each AMC	Scheme Information Document, Key Information Memorandum, Statement of Additional Information, monthly factsheets with full portfolios, risk-o-meter, expense ratios	The authoritative source for what a scheme is permitted to do. Read the SID before the marketing material.
Depository CAS	nsdl.co.in, cdslindia.com	Consolidated statement covering demat holdings and, in the consolidated version, mutual fund holdings across registrars	Issued to your registered email; request if not received

> **Why SPIVA matters more than any rating**
> A star rating tells you which funds did well in the past, which is weakly related to which will do well in future. SPIVA tells you what proportion of active managers in a category beat their benchmark over various horizons, after correcting for funds that were merged or closed. That is a structural fact about the category, and it is the right input to the **active versus passive** decision — which comes before any fund selection decision. **Read the current India scorecard directly at the source rather than a summary of it; results vary by category and by period, and summaries routinely cherry-pick.** The mutual funds guide discusses what to do with the finding.

What to actually look at when evaluating a scheme

- ☐ **Category** — the SEBI-mandated category determines what the fund may hold. Check this before anything else.
- ☐ **Benchmark** — and whether it is a Total Return Index. Comparison against a price index flatters the fund by roughly 1–1.5 percentage points a year.
- ☐ **Expense ratio, direct plan** — and the difference versus the regular plan, which is the commission you would otherwise pay.
- ☐ **Rolling returns**, not point-to-point returns. A fund's "5-year return" depends heavily on the start date chosen; rolling returns over many overlapping windows do not.

- [ ] **Portfolio holdings and overlap** with what you already own.
- [ ] **Portfolio turnover** — high turnover means costs inside the fund that do not appear in the expense ratio.
- [ ] **Fund size** relative to the strategy. A small-cap strategy at very large scale cannot execute the same way it did when small.
- [ ] **Manager tenure** — a ten-year track record under three different managers is three track records.
- [ ] **For debt funds**: modified duration, credit quality breakdown, and the proportion in instruments below the top rating. See the debt section of the portfolio construction guide.
- [ ] **Risk-o-meter** and the scheme's own stated risk level — and whether it has changed.

Macro and Flow Data — What Each Actually Tells You

A great deal of daily market commentary consists of reciting flow and sentiment numbers as though they were forecasts. Most of them describe what has already happened. A few are mildly useful as context. Almost none supports an action for a long-horizon investor, and knowing which is which saves a great deal of time.

Indicator	Where	What it genuinely tells you	What it does not tell you	Worth checking
FII / DII daily net flows	NSE, BSE, and aggregated by most data platforms	Who was a net buyer and seller in the cash segment yesterday	Direction. Flows are as much a *result* of price as a cause, the data covers only part of foreign activity, and derivative positions are reported separately.	Weekly at most, as context
NSDL / CDSL FPI data	Depository websites, and the FPI monitor pages	Foreign portfolio investment flows by sector and by category, with more granularity than the daily headline, usually fortnightly or monthly	Near-term direction	Monthly if you are interested in sector positioning
India VIX	NSE	The market's expectation of near-term volatility, derived from index option prices	Direction. High VIX means large expected moves, not down moves. It is a measure of uncertainty, not of pessimism.	Only relevant if you trade options
Advance-decline ratio	Exchange sites and data platforms	Breadth — how many stocks participated in a move. A rally carried by a handful of large companies has different internals from a broad one.	Timing	Monthly, as a sanity check on headline index moves

Put-call ratio	NSE option data and aggregators	The ratio of put to call open interest or volume; often cited as a sentiment measure	Very little reliably. Interpretation is contested, the ratio is distorted by institutional hedging, and the "contrarian at extremes" claim is much weaker than commonly asserted.	Rarely, and only with scepticism
Government bond yields	RBI, exchange and data platforms	The risk-free rate and the market's view on inflation and policy. The **10-year G-Sec yield** is the single most important number in Indian finance and is almost never mentioned on business television.	Equity direction	**Weekly.** This is the number worth knowing.
Yield curve shape	RBI, CCIL	Market expectations of the path of rates	A precise recession signal; the Indian curve's history is shorter and the relationship less studied than in the US	Monthly
CPI inflation	MoSPI	The main input to monetary policy, and a reality check on your own return assumptions	Your personal inflation rate, which for education, healthcare and services is typically higher	Monthly

GST collections	CBIC / finance ministry	A high-frequency, broad-based proxy for economic activity	Precision — it is affected by rate changes, compliance drives and base effects	Monthly, as context
RBI policy calendar	rbi.org.in	When decisions will be announced	What they will be	Put the dates in your calendar once a year
Results calendar	Exchanges and data platforms	When your holdings report	—	Quarterly, for direct holdings
Economic calendar	Most data platforms and news sites	Scheduled data releases and events	Market reaction	Weekly glance at most
Crude oil and the rupee	Any market data source	Two of the most consequential external variables for the Indian economy	Anything with enough precision to act on	Monthly

✕ **Flow data is a description, not a prediction**

"FIIs sold ₹3,200 crore (32,000,000,000 rupees) yesterday" is a statement about the past. It is reported as though it carries predictive content because it is available daily, is easy to report, and sounds specific. There is no reliable evidence that daily institutional flow data gives a retail investor an actionable edge, and acting on it means trading against institutions with better information and lower costs. For a long-horizon investor following the process in the portfolio construction guide, **daily flow data has no legitimate use at all**. Its main function is to fill airtime.

TEXT

THE MACRO DASHBOARD WORTH KEEPING
(once a month, 10 minutes, written down)

Date: _____

1. 10-year G-Sec yield _____ %
   (change vs last month) _____ pp
   WHY: it is the discount rate for every asset you own, and the alternative return your debt sleeve can lock in.

2. CPI inflation, latest print _____ %
   WHY: your real return is nominal minus this. It is also the input to your goal inflation assumptions.

3. Repo rate _____ %
   Next policy date _____
   WHY: the anchor for everything in the debt sleeve.

4. USD/INR _____
   (change over 12 months) _____ %
   WHY: it is a component of the return on your international allocation.

5. Equity market level vs its own 10-year range (roughly: cheap / middling / expensive on whatever long-run measure you have chosen and stated in advance)
   _____
   WHY: context only. This does NOT trigger an action under a policy allocation - see the portfolio construction guide on why tactical allocation usually fails.

6. Anything that changed in tax law or regulation affecting a holding
   _____

THAT IS THE ENTIRE MACRO DIET. Six lines a month. Everything else is either derived from these or is not actionable.

News Sources, Ranked Honestly

News tells you that something happened. It rarely tells you what it means, and it is structurally incapable of telling you that nothing happened, which is the correct answer most days. The practical approach is to use a small number of sources with a known character, read them on a schedule rather than continuously, and treat every claim as a pointer to a primary document.

Category	Examples	Strong at	Weak at	How to use
Wire services	Reuters; Bloomberg; PTI	Speed and factual accuracy on events; global context; wires are the upstream source for most domestic coverage	Depth; India-specific regulatory nuance; much of Bloomberg's best content is behind a terminal or paywall	For verifying that a widely circulated story is real
Business dailies — analytical	Mint; Business Standard; Hindu BusinessLine	Policy coverage, sectoral analysis, columns with genuine expertise, occasional investigative work. Business Standard is generally strong on policy and corporate governance; Mint on markets and data journalism; BusinessLine on agriculture, commodities and the banking sector	Volume still exceeds signal; opinion columns vary enormously in quality within the same publication	One of them, once a day, for fifteen minutes. Not three of them continuously.
Business dailies — high volume	Economic Times	Breadth of coverage, breaking corporate news, large reporting network	High article volume including a lot of thin, list-style and stock-specific content designed for traffic; headline tone often stronger than the body	Useful for breadth; discount the stock-specific "this share may give X%" genre entirely

Portals	Moneycontrol	Comprehensive data pages, filings aggregation, results coverage, a very large archive, usable mobile app	A high proportion of trading-oriented and tip-adjacent content; recommendation-style articles; heavy advertising; distinguishing editorial from sponsored content requires attention	Excellent as a **data and filings** destination. Treat the "top picks" and "stocks to watch" genre as entertainment.
Broadcast	Business television generally	Live coverage of budget day, policy announcements and major results; occasional substantive long-form interviews	**Structurally the worst format for an investor.** Continuous commentary on price movement, guests with undisclosed positions, a requirement to have a view on everything within thirty seconds, and an explicit design goal of keeping you watching	Scheduled events only. Avoid as a daily habit.
International	Reuters; Financial Times; Bloomberg	Global macro, cross-border context, high editorial standards, genuine investigative capacity	Limited India depth; paywalled; sometimes applies a framing to India that does not fit	Valuable if you hold international exposure. One, weekly.
Specialist and newsletter journalism	Several independent Indian outlets	Depth on specific beats, including corporate governance and accounting, that mainstream	Small teams; coverage is narrow; subscription cost	Worth one subscription if the beat matches your holdings

		outlets do not sustain		

> **How to read a business news article in 40 seconds**
> **(1)** Does the headline match the body? Headlines are written by someone other than the reporter and are optimised for clicks. **(2)** Is there a named source, a document, or a filing reference? "Sources said" and "according to people familiar with the matter" mean the claim is unverifiable by you. **(3)** Is a number given with its base and period? "Profit jumped 200%" from a near-zero base is arithmetic, not performance. **(4)** Is this an event or an opinion about an event? **(5)** If it matters, go to the filing. If it does not, stop reading.

What to exclude entirely

- ☐ Any article whose headline contains a price target, a percentage return, or the phrase "this stock may".
- ☐ WhatsApp and Telegram forwards about specific securities, without exception. See the pump-and-dump section.
- ☐ Anything framed as "experts say" without naming the experts and their positions.
- ☐ "Top N stocks for" anything — the year, the festival season, the budget, retirement.
- ☐ Any source that has never, in your experience of it, published a correction or revisited a wrong call.
- ☐ Push notifications from news and broker apps. **Turn all of them off.** There is no market event that needs to interrupt you.

Free Learning Resources

The quality of free investor education available in India is high, and it is mostly ignored in favour of paid courses that repackage it. Three sources cover almost everything a retail investor needs, and all three are free.

Resource	URL	What it covers	Honest assessment
Zerodha Varsity	zerodha.com/varsity	Modules on market basics, technical analysis, fundamental analysis, futures, options theory and strategy, risk management, personal finance, markets and taxation, with worked examples throughout	Comprehensive, well written, genuinely free, and by a wide margin the best structured introduction available for an Indian audience. **Note the commercial context: it is published by a broker, and the options modules are necessarily describing an activity the publisher earns revenue from.** The content itself is notably more balanced about risk than most broker-published material, but read the trading risk guide alongside the derivatives modules.
SEBI investor education	sebi.gov.in and SEBI's investor website	Booklets, FAQs, caution notices, regional-language material, investor awareness programmes, and the periodic research studies	Accurate, authoritative and completely free of product interest — a combination that exists nowhere else. Less engaging than commercial material, which is a feature. **The research studies on retail outcomes in the derivatives segment are the most consequential free reading for anyone considering that activity.**
NISM certifications	nism.ac.in	The certification framework for market intermediaries: equity derivatives, mutual fund distribution, investment advisers, research analysts, depository operations and more. Study material is published for each.	The **workbooks are a structured syllabus** even if you never sit the examination. Certification is a regulatory requirement for people working in these roles; for an individual investor it is optional but the material is solid. There is a fee for the examination.

RBI and exchange investor material	rbi.org.in, nseindia.com, bseindia.com	Investor awareness content, market operation explainers, certification programmes run by the exchanges	Variable but accurate; strong on market mechanics
AMFI investor awareness	amfiindia.com	Mutual fund basics, categorisation, risk	Accurate on mechanics; necessarily positive about the industry it represents

Books worth reading

A short list, chosen because each teaches a transferable way of thinking rather than a technique that expires. None is India-specific, which is their main limitation — pair each with the India-specific material in this study pack.

Book	Author	What it is for
The Intelligent Investor	Benjamin Graham	The distinction between investment and speculation, the margin-of-safety idea, and the chapters on investor psychology. Dated in its specifics; the framework is not.
A Random Walk Down Wall Street	Burton Malkiel	The case for indexing and the honest evidence on active management and forecasting
The Little Book of Common Sense Investing	John Bogle	Costs, compounding and why the arithmetic of active management is unforgiving. Short.
Thinking, Fast and Slow	Daniel Kahneman	The cognitive biases that cause almost all behavioural investing errors. Not a finance book, which is why it works.
The Psychology of Money	Morgan Housel	Accessible treatment of why financial behaviour diverges from financial theory. Short, non-technical.
Financial Shenanigans	Howard Schilit and others	How accounting is manipulated and how to spot it in the statements. Directly applicable to reading an annual report.
Against the Gods	Peter Bernstein	The history of how humanity learned to think about risk. Context rather than technique.
Poor Charlie's Almanack	Charles Munger (ed. Peter Kaufman)	Mental models and the discipline of inversion — asking what would make you wrong
Expectations Investing	Michael Mauboussin and Alfred Rappaport	Reading the expectations already embedded in a price, rather than forecasting from scratch
The Most Important Thing	Howard Marks	Risk, cycles, and second-level thinking

✦ **Read slowly and once, not quickly and many**

Reading ten investing books in a year produces less than reading two carefully and writing down what you would do differently. The marginal book is almost always a restatement. **The binding constraint is behaviour, not knowledge**, and no additional book fixes behaviour — a written Investment Policy Statement does, which is why it is the first thing in the portfolio construction guide.

Newsletters, Podcasts and Video — How to Evaluate a Source

Independent commentary is where the best and the worst financial content both live. There is no institutional filter, which means genuinely expert individuals publish alongside people whose entire business model is your trading activity. The evaluation questions below are worth applying to every source before it enters your routine, including the long-standing ones.

The conflict-of-interest questions

1. **How does this person make money?**
   If the answer is unclear after five minutes of looking, that is the answer. Advertising, sponsorship, courses, affiliate links to brokers, subscription fees, and holding the securities discussed are all different incentive structures with different distortions.

2. **Are they SEBI-registered, and as what?**
   Providing personalised investment advice requires registration as an **investment adviser**. Publishing research requires registration as a **research analyst**. Neither registration is required for general education.
   Someone recommending specific securities to a general audience without registration is operating outside the framework — verify the current requirements at sebi.gov.in.

3. **Do they disclose positions?**
   A credible source discloses whether they hold what they are discussing, and says when that changes. A research analyst is subject to specific disclosure requirements.

4. **Is there an affiliate relationship with a broker or platform?**
   A referral link means they are paid when you open an account. That is not disqualifying if disclosed; it is disqualifying if hidden.

5. **Do they take sponsorship from the entities they cover?**
   And is sponsored content clearly labelled every time, or only sometimes?

6. **What happens to their old calls?**
   Is the archive complete and searchable, or has it been curated? Do they revisit a thesis that failed, and in the same format and prominence as the original?

7

Do they ever say "I do not know"?

Markets produce genuine uncertainty constantly. A source that is confident about everything has replaced analysis with performance.

8

Do they distinguish between education and recommendation?

"Here is how a cash flow statement works" and "here is what to buy" are different activities with different regulatory consequences. A source that blurs them deliberately is telling you something.

9

What is the implied time horizon?

Content optimised for weekly publication cannot be about decade-horizon investing, because nothing changes weekly at that horizon. The cadence constrains the content.

10

Would you still value this if the market fell 40%?

The honest test. Most high-frequency commentary becomes obviously useless in a crisis, which is when you most need judgement.

Specific red flags

Red flag	Why it matters
Guaranteed or assured returns	Not possible in securities. Claiming it is a regulatory red flag in itself.
Screenshots of profits as the main credential	Trivially fabricated — see the detection section. Also survivorship: a screenshot of a winning trade says nothing about the ninety losing ones.
Accuracy percentages ("90% accurate calls")	Accuracy is not profitability. A strategy that wins 90% of the time with small gains and loses 10% with large ones is a losing strategy. The claim is also unverifiable.
Urgency — "only 50 seats", "price rises tomorrow", "this stock will move Monday"	Scarcity and urgency are sales techniques. Genuine analysis does not expire on Friday.
Specific entry, target and stop-loss broadcast to a mass audience	Personalised advice requires registration; broadcasting identical "calls" to thousands of people is not personalised in any case, and raises the question of who is on the other side.
Requests for your trading credentials or for "managed" accounts	Never acceptable, under any circumstance, from anyone.
Profit-sharing arrangements	Subject to specific regulatory constraints. An unregistered person proposing it is a serious warning.
Payment to a personal bank account or by UPI to an individual	No legitimate registered intermediary needs this.
Testimonials from anonymous accounts	Costless to manufacture.
No archive, or content that disappears	Deleted posts after a failed call are the clearest possible signal.
Heavy focus on small, illiquid companies	These are the securities where a promotion campaign can actually move the price. See the next section.
"SEBI registered" claimed without a number	Or with a number that does not match the entity name in the database. Check, every time.

Detecting Pumps, Paid Promotion and Fabrication

Market manipulation aimed at retail investors is not hypothetical in India; SEBI's enforcement orders describe the mechanics in detail, repeatedly. The schemes are not sophisticated. They work because they are fast, emotionally compelling, and arrive through channels that feel personal.



Schematic only, not real price data. The key structural feature is the right-hand side: a security that rose on thin volume falls through successive lower circuits with no buyers, so the paper loss cannot be realised at any price near it.

Pump-and-dump — the signatures

- ☐ A **small, illiquid company** with a low free float and low average traded volume — the only kind where a campaign can move the price.
- ☐ A sudden, unexplained price rise on **volume far above the recent average**, often with repeated upper circuits.
- ☐ **No corresponding exchange filing** that explains the move, and no clarification from the company.
- ☐ **Coordinated messaging** appearing across several channels at once, with similar phrasing and a specific target price.
- ☐ A narrative involving a transformative order, a name change, a new business line, or an association with a currently fashionable theme.
- ☐ The security appears on an exchange's **graded surveillance** or **trade-to-trade** list — check this before anything else.

- ☐ Promoter pledge or promoter holding changes in the recent shareholding pattern.
- ☐ Urgency: "buy before Monday", "last chance below X".
- ☐ The channel that promoted it goes quiet, or deletes messages, once the price turns.

✕ **Why the loss is usually total rather than partial**

The mechanism that makes these schemes profitable for the operator is the same one that traps you. The security is illiquid by design. On the way up, thin volume means small buying moves the price a lot. On the way down, there is no natural buyer at any price, so the security hits successive **lower circuits** with no trades executed. You cannot sell at −20% or −40%, because there is nobody on the other side. Investors in these situations routinely find that the first price at which they can actually exit is 70–90% below where they bought. **Read a few of SEBI's enforcement orders in this area at sebi.gov.in; the mechanics are described plainly and the deterrent effect of reading three of them is considerable.**

Detecting paid promotion

Signal	What to check
Sudden coverage of a company the source has never mentioned	Search the source's archive for any prior mention. Promoted coverage usually appears without history.
Uniformly positive framing with no risk discussion	Genuine analysis contains a "what could go wrong" section. Promotion does not.
Several unconnected sources covering the same small company in the same week	Coordination. Compare the phrasing — promoted content frequently reuses the same supplied talking points.
Disclosure buried, abbreviated or absent	Look for "sponsored", "partnered content", "in association with", or an asterisk at the very end. Inconsistent labelling across a source's output is itself a signal.
Heavy use of the company's own investor presentation imagery	Suggests supplied material rather than independent work
Coverage timed just before a lock-in expiry, a preferential allotment or a large promoter sale	Check the exchange filings for what is scheduled

Detecting a fabricated screenshot or track record

- [ ] Profit-and-loss screenshots are **editable in a browser's developer tools in under a minute**. They carry no evidential weight whatsoever, from anyone.
- [ ] Look for internal inconsistency: does the percentage match the absolute amount? Does the date match a trading day? Does the quantity match a valid lot size for that instrument?
- [ ] A screenshot of a single winning position says nothing about the account. Ask for the **full account statement for a full year**, including losses, and note how often that request is refused.
- [ ] Verified track records in this space are rare. A genuine one would be a broker-issued statement or an audited record covering a complete period, not an app screenshot.
- [ ] Be alert to **survivorship within one person's own output**: ten "calls" are made, three work, three are screenshotted, seven are never mentioned again.
- [ ] Check whether the claimed return is even plausible. Sustained returns far above what large, well-resourced institutions achieve, by an individual, posted publicly for free, is not a likely configuration.
- [ ] Impersonation is common: fake accounts using the name and photograph of a genuine, well-known investor or of a registered intermediary. **Check SEBI's caution notices and press releases, and verify the entity in the intermediary database rather than trusting a profile.**

TEXT

```
A FOUR-MINUTE DUE DILIGENCE ROUTINE
Run this before engaging with ANY source that
mentions a specific security.

 1. SEBI INTERMEDIARY DATABASE
    sebi.gov.in → intermediaries → search the
    exact registered entity name.
    - registered?            yes / no
    - category matches what they are doing?
                             yes / no
    If NO to either: STOP. Nothing below
    matters.

 2. SEBI ENFORCEMENT AND CAUTION
    Search the entity and individual names in
    SEBI orders and press releases.
    - any adverse order?     yes / no

 3. THE SECURITY ITSELF
    Exchange site → check:
    - on a surveillance measure list?
                             yes / no
    - average daily traded volume over the
      last 3 months          _________
    - free float / promoter holding
                             _________
    - promoter pledge %      _________
    If volume is low and the price has moved
    sharply: assume a pump until proven
    otherwise.

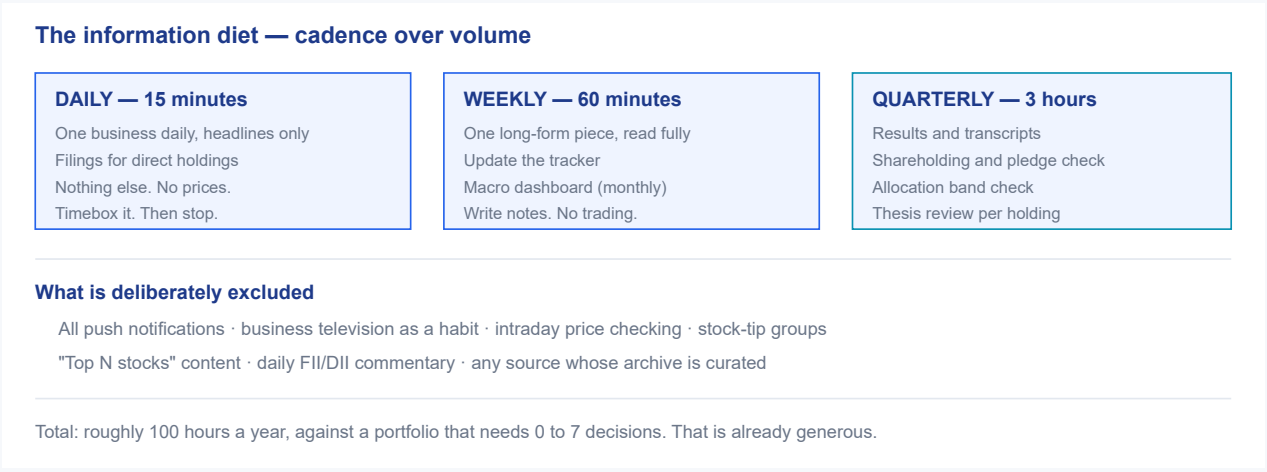
 4. THE FILING TEST
    Exchange corporate announcements → is
    there ANY filing that explains the move or
    the claim?
    - yes: read it. The filing is the fact.
    - no:  the claim is unsupported. STOP.

 5. THE INCENTIVE TEST
    Why is this person telling me this, for
    free, rather than simply buying it
    themselves?
    Write the answer down. If you cannot, that
    is the answer.

FOUR MINUTES. This single routine prevents the
large majority of retail losses that are not
caused by the investor's own impatience.
```

Building Your Own System: The Reading Routine

An information system is not a list of sources. It is a schedule, a set of exclusions, and a place for what you learn to go. Without a schedule, consumption expands to fill available time. Without exclusions, the worst sources crowd out the best, because they are designed to. Without a destination, nothing you read compounds.



The schedule is the system. Sources without a schedule become a feed, and a feed is optimised for someone else's objectives.

Daily — 15 minutes, at a fixed time

- ☐ One business daily. **Headlines only**, open at most two articles. Fifteen minutes on a timer.
- ☐ Exchange filing alerts for your direct holdings, if you have any. Read the filing, not the coverage of it.
- ☐ **Do not look at prices.** Price checking is the single most behaviourally corrosive daily habit; the more often you see a loss, the more risk-averse you become, which is precisely backwards for a long-horizon investor.
- ☐ Do not open a trading app unless you are executing a pre-decided transaction.
- ☐ When the timer ends, stop, whether or not you finished. There is always more; that is the nature of the supply.

Weekly — 60 minutes, same slot each week

- [ ] One **long-form** piece read properly — an annual report section, a rating rationale, a transcript, a regulator publication, or a book chapter. Depth once beats breadth seven times.
- [ ] Update the portfolio tracker: transactions, charges, current values. Fifteen minutes.
- [ ] Check the 10-year G-Sec yield and note it. Thirty seconds.
- [ ] Write **three sentences** in your notes: what you learned, what you are uncertain about, what you are doing (usually nothing).
- [ ] Clear the "read later" queue ruthlessly. Anything older than two weeks was not important.
- [ ] **No transactions during this session.** Reviewing and acting are separate activities and must be separated in time, or the review becomes a justification exercise.

Monthly — 20 minutes

- [ ] The six-line macro dashboard from the earlier section.
- [ ] AMFI monthly category flow data, as a contrarian temperature check only.
- [ ] RBI Bulletin's "State of the Economy" article, skimmed.
- [ ] Check that every standing instruction executed.

Quarterly — 3 hours

- [ ] Results and earnings call transcripts for every direct holding, using the 15-minute template.
- [ ] Shareholding pattern and promoter pledge for every direct holding.
- [ ] Allocation band check per the portfolio construction guide; act only if a band is breached.
- [ ] Thesis review: for each direct holding, has a pre-written "what would make me wrong" condition triggered?
- [ ] Source audit: which sources did you actually use this quarter, and which did you merely consume? Remove two.

Annually — half a day

- [ ] Annual reports for direct holdings, using the 90-minute order, compared against the prior year.
- [ ] The current SPIVA India scorecard, read with its methodology.
- [ ] The Economic Survey.
- [ ] Your own decision log for the year, read start to finish. This is the only honest calibration available.
- [ ] The full annual review per the portfolio construction guide — life facts, insurance, savings rate, goals, allocation, XIRR versus benchmark, costs, tax, nominations.

Notes, Watchlists and Alerts

Reading without recording produces the impression of knowledge and none of the benefit. The system below is deliberately minimal — three files and a short list of alerts — because an elaborate note-taking system is a procrastination structure, not a research structure.

The three files

File	Contents	Updated	Why
1. Decision log	Date, what you did, why, what you expected, how you felt, and what the alternative was	Every transaction, plus a line each week	The only defence against hindsight bias. Reading an entry written at the bottom of a drawdown, three years later, teaches more than any book.
2. Thesis notes	One per direct holding or active fund: why you bought, what you expect, **what would make you wrong**, maximum position size, review triggers	At purchase; reviewed quarterly; **never rewritten retroactively**	Converts selling from an emotional decision into a conditional one. The template is in the portfolio construction guide.
3. Learning file	Three sentences a week: what you learned, what you are uncertain about, what you did	Weekly, in the same session	Forces synthesis. If you cannot write three sentences, the week's reading produced nothing — which is itself worth knowing.

A watchlist structure that works

TEXT

```
THREE TIERS, WITH DIFFERENT RULES

TIER 1 - OWNED  (what I hold)
  Review: quarterly, in full
  Alerts: exchange filings only
  Note required: a thesis note per position
  Action rule: only per the thesis note or the
    rebalancing policy

TIER 2 - STUDYING  (5-10 names maximum)
  Businesses I am actively reading about and
  might own one day.
  Review: when results are filed
  Alerts: none
  Note required: a half-page on what I do not
    yet understand about this business
  Action rule: NO PURCHASE until the thesis
    note is complete, including the "what would
    make me wrong" section
  EXIT RULE: if I have not made progress on a
    name in two quarters, remove it. A stale
    watchlist is a to-do list that generates
    guilt, not research.

TIER 3 - PARKED  (anything else)
  Names I have looked at and set aside, with
  ONE LINE on why.
  Review: never, unless something specific
    changes
  Alerts: none
  Note required: the one line
  PURPOSE: so that when the name resurfaces in
    two years you do not redo the work. "Parked
    Mar-2026: cyclical at peak margins, leverage
    too high for my limits" takes ten seconds to
    write and saves four hours later.

HARD CAP: Tier 1 + Tier 2 must total fewer than
20 names for a part-time investor. Beyond that
you are not tracking anything, you are
collecting tickers.

WHAT DOES NOT BELONG ON A WATCHLIST
  - anything you heard about this week
  - anything whose appeal is that it has risen
  - anything you cannot describe in four
    sentences
  - anything on a surveillance measure list
```

Alerts worth setting, and alerts that just create anxiety

Alert	Worth it?	Reasoning
Exchange filing alert for a held company	**Yes**	Material events are what you actually need to know, and the exchanges offer email subscription by company
Results date reminders for holdings	**Yes**	Lets you schedule the transcript reading rather than discovering it late
Rebalancing band breach	**Yes**	A rule-based trigger tied to a pre-written action
Pre-decided drawdown levels from your IPS	**Yes**	−20%, −30%, −40% on the portfolio, each tied to a written instruction you already agreed to
SIP execution confirmation	**Yes**	A failed standing instruction is silent and costs a month of contributions
Annual and quarterly review calendar entries	**Yes**	The process only exists if it is scheduled
Tax dates — advance tax, filing, March harvesting window	**Yes**	See the tax guide calendar
Daily portfolio value notification	**No**	Pure anxiety generation. The more frequently you observe a volatile series, the more often you see a loss, and the worse your risk decisions become.
Index level alerts	**No**	There is no action attached. An alert without a pre-written action is a notification you will respond to emotionally.
News alerts for a sector or keyword	**No**	High volume, no actionability, and they arrive at random times
Price target alerts on watchlist names	**Mostly no**	Only if attached to a written, pre-committed buy decision with a size. Otherwise it is a prompt to act on a number you made up.
Any broker app push notification	**No**	Turn them all off. Every one of them exists to increase your engagement, which means your turnover.

The rule for every alert

No alert without a pre-written action. Before enabling anything, write the sentence: "When this fires, I will do X." If you cannot complete the sentence, the alert is a source of anxiety with no decision attached, and it should not exist. Applying this rule typically removes about 80% of a new investor's notifications.

An information diet smaller than you think

TEXT

```
THE FINAL SOURCE LIST FOR A LONG-HORIZON
INDIAN INVESTOR

PRIMARY (check only when needed)
  1. NSE / BSE - filings for direct holdings
  2. SEBI      - regulations, orders, studies
  3. RBI       - policy, bulletin, DBIE
  4. AMFI      - NAV, category flows
  5. Your registrar / depository - statements

ANALYTICAL (as required)
  6. One screener
  7. One fund research site
  8. SPIVA scorecard (annually)

NEWS (one, daily, 15 minutes)
  9. One business daily

LEARNING (as the mood takes you)
 10. Varsity / SEBI investor material / books

THAT IS TEN SOURCES. Not forty.

EXCLUDED, DELIBERATELY
  - all WhatsApp and Telegram groups about
    securities
  - business television as a daily habit
  - all push notifications
  - any source offering specific buy
    recommendations to a mass audience
  - any source whose business model depends on
    your trading frequency
  - "top N stocks" content in any form

THE TEST FOR ADDING AN ELEVENTH SOURCE
  What decision will this change that the
  existing ten do not inform?
  If you cannot answer, do not add it. If you
  can, REMOVE one of the ten first. The
  constraint is attention, and attention is the
  only input you cannot buy more of.
```

APIs and Light Automation

A small amount of automation removes the tedious parts of tracking — fetching NAVs, computing allocation drift, computing XIRR — without creating a system you have to maintain. The ambition should be deliberately low. A script that updates a spreadsheet is useful; a script that places orders is a different activity with different risks.

> ⚠ **Read the terms before you automate against anyone's site**
> Exchange and data provider websites have **terms of use**, and many apply rate limiting, require session headers, or prohibit automated access outright. Scraping a site that forbids it is a terms violation and may be blocked or actioned. **Prefer official downloadable files and documented APIs over scraping.** Broker APIs are typically a paid, authenticated service with their own terms and their own security obligations on you. **Verify the current terms of any source before automating against it.**

What is worth automating, and what is not

Task	Automate?	Why
Fetching daily NAVs for your funds	**Yes**	AMFI publishes a daily NAV file in a documented, stable, plain-text format. This is the single highest-value automation available to an Indian retail investor.
Computing allocation drift against policy weights	**Yes**	Pure arithmetic on data you already have
Computing portfolio and per-goal XIRR	**Yes**	Tedious by hand, trivial in code, and the number that actually matters
Downloading end-of-day price files	Yes, from official downloads	Exchanges publish daily files; use those rather than scraping pages
Generating a quarterly review report	Yes	Removes the friction that causes reviews to be skipped
Fetching and storing your own broker's trade data	Maybe	Only if your broker offers a documented API and you handle credentials properly. The manual download is usually fine.
Scraping fundamental data from screeners	**No**	Almost always against terms, fragile, and you can export what you need
Automated order placement	**No**, for the purposes of this guide	This is algorithmic trading, with a completely different risk profile, regulatory considerations and failure modes. See the trading risk guide. Nothing in a long-term portfolio needs it.
Automated "signals" or alerts on technical conditions	**No**	Generates actions without a pre-written decision rule — exactly the thing the alerts rule forbids

A simple portfolio tracker in Python

PYTHON

```
"""
A minimal Indian portfolio tracker.

Reads two CSV files you maintain by hand, fetches
current mutual fund NAVs from AMFI's published daily
NAV file, and prints:
  - current value by asset class
  - drift against your policy weights
  - portfolio XIRR

No trading. No credentials. No broker API.
Read AMFI's terms of use before scheduling this.

holdings.csv
    scheme_code,asset_class,units
    119551,IN-EQ-BROAD,1243.871
    120503,INTL-EQ,884.220
    118989,GOLD,610.405
    103504,DEBT-SHORT,2204.118

flows.csv   (negative = money you put in)
    date,amount
    2021-04-05,-200000
    2021-05-05,-25000
    2026-03-31,0        # leave 0; value is added
"""

import csv
import urllib.request
from datetime import date, datetime

AMFI_NAV_URL = "https://www.amfiindia.com/spages/NAVAll.txt"

POLICY = {
    "IN-EQ-BROAD": 0.45,
    "IN-EQ-MIDSMALL": 0.10,
    "INTL-EQ": 0.12,
    "GOLD": 0.10,
    "DEBT-SHORT": 0.23,
}
BAND = 0.05  # absolute percentage points


def fetch_navs():
    """AMFI publishes a semicolon-delimited daily file.

    Columns are, in order:
      Scheme Code; ISIN Div Payout/Growth; ISIN Div
```

```
      Reinvestment; Scheme Name; Net Asset Value; Date

    Header and category lines do not have 6 fields, so
    they are skipped naturally.
    """
    navs = {}
    req = urllib.request.Request(
        AMFI_NAV_URL,
        headers={"User-Agent": "personal-portfolio-tracker"},
    )
    with urllib.request.urlopen(req, timeout=30) as resp:
        text = resp.read().decode("utf-8", errors="replace")

    for line in text.splitlines():
        parts = line.split(";")
        if len(parts) != 6:
            continue
        code, _, _, name, nav, nav_date = parts
        code = code.strip()
        try:
            navs[code] = {
                "nav": float(nav.strip()),
                "name": name.strip(),
                "date": nav_date.strip(),
            }
        except ValueError:
            continue  # header row, or "N.A." for a stale NAV
    return navs


def read_holdings(path="holdings.csv"):
    rows = []
    with open(path, newline="", encoding="utf-8") as f:
        for row in csv.DictReader(f):
            rows.append(
                {
                    "scheme_code": row["scheme_code"].strip(),
                    "asset_class": row["asset_class"].strip(),
                    "units": float(row["units"]),
                }
            )
    return rows


def read_flows(path="flows.csv"):
    flows = []
    with open(path, newline="", encoding="utf-8") as f:
        for row in csv.DictReader(f):
            d = datetime.strptime(row["date"].strip(), "%Y-%m-%d").date()
```

```
            amt = float(row["amount"])
            if amt != 0.0:
                flows.append((d, amt))
    flows.sort(key=lambda x: x[0])
    return flows


def xnpv(rate, flows):
    t0 = flows[0][0]
    return sum(
        cf / (1.0 + rate) ** ((d - t0).days / 365.0)
        for d, cf in flows
    )


def xirr(flows, lo=-0.9999, hi=10.0, tol=1e-7, iters=400):
    """Bisection. Robust enough for a normal investor's
    flow pattern (many negatives, one positive at the end).
    Returns None if it cannot bracket a root."""
    if xnpv(lo, flows) * xnpv(hi, flows) > 0:
        return None
    for _ in range(iters):
        mid = (lo + hi) / 2.0
        v = xnpv(mid, flows)
        if abs(v) < tol:
            return mid
        if v > 0:
            lo = mid
        else:
            hi = mid
    return (lo + hi) / 2.0


def inr(x):
    """Format in the Indian grouping convention."""
    neg = x < 0
    s = "{:.0f}".format(abs(x))
    if len(s) <= 3:
        out = s
    else:
        head, tail = s[:-3], s[-3:]
        groups = []
        while len(head) > 2:
            groups.insert(0, head[-2:])
            head = head[:-2]
        if head:
            groups.insert(0, head)
        out = ",".join(groups) + "," + tail
    return ("-" if neg else "") + "Rs " + out
```

```
def main():
    navs = fetch_navs()
    holdings = read_holdings()

    by_class = {}
    total = 0.0
    stale = []

    for h in holdings:
        info = navs.get(h["scheme_code"])
        if info is None:
            stale.append(h["scheme_code"])
            continue
        value = info["nav"] * h["units"]
        by_class[h["asset_class"]] = (
            by_class.get(h["asset_class"], 0.0) + value
        )
        total += value

    if stale:
        print("WARNING - scheme codes not found in the AMFI file:")
        for code in stale:
            print("   ", code)
        print("   Check the code, or the scheme may have merged.\n")

    print("PORTFOLIO AS AT", date.today().isoformat())
    print("=" * 56)
    print("{:<18}{:>16}{:>9}{:>9}".format(
        "ASSET CLASS", "VALUE", "ACTUAL", "TARGET"))
    print("-" * 56)

    breaches = []
    for cls in POLICY:
        value = by_class.get(cls, 0.0)
        actual = value / total if total else 0.0
        target = POLICY[cls]
        drift = actual - target
        flag = ""
        if abs(drift) > BAND:
            flag = "  BAND BREACH"
            breaches.append((cls, drift, (target - actual) * total))
        print("{:<18}{:>16}{:>8.1f}%{:>8.1f}%{}".format(
            cls, inr(value), actual * 100, target * 100, flag))

    unmapped = set(by_class) - set(POLICY)
    for cls in sorted(unmapped):
        print("{:<18}{:>16}{:>9}{:>9}  NOT IN POLICY".format(
```

```
            cls, inr(by_class[cls]), "-", "-"))

    print("-" * 56)
    print("{:<18}{:>16}".format("TOTAL", inr(total)))

    if breaches:
        print("\nREBALANCING REQUIRED")
        for cls, drift, rupees in breaches:
            action = "BUY " if rupees > 0 else "SELL"
            print("  {} {:<16} {} (drift {:+.1f}pp)".format(
                action, cls, inr(abs(rupees)), drift * 100))
        print("\n  Before selling anything, try routing the next")
        print("  few months of contributions to the underweight")
        print("  asset first. See the portfolio construction guide.")
    else:
        print("\nAll asset classes within bands. No action required.")

    flows = read_flows()
    flows.append((date.today(), total))
    rate = xirr(flows)
    if rate is None:
        print("\nXIRR: could not converge. Check the flow signs -")
        print("the first flow must be negative and the final")
        print("portfolio value must be a positive flow.")
    else:
        invested = -sum(a for _, a in flows if a < 0)
        print("\nTotal invested     ", inr(invested))
        print("Current value      ", inr(total))
        print("Portfolio XIRR      {:.2f}% p.a.".format(rate * 100))
        print("\nCompare this against your BLENDED benchmark's")
        print("time-weighted return, not against an equity index.")


if __name__ == "__main__":
    main()
```

What this script deliberately does not do

It does not connect to a broker, hold any credential, place any order, store anything in a database, or offer any opinion about what you should own. It reads two files you maintain, fetches a public NAV file, and prints three numbers. That is the correct scope for personal portfolio automation. Anything beyond it adds maintenance burden and security surface for no decision-making benefit. **If you extend it, keep credentials out of the source file and out of version control, and read your broker's API terms and security requirements before authenticating against anything.**

Other light automation worth having

Automation	Approach	Effort
Email alerts for filings by a held company	Subscribe on the exchange website — no code required	Five minutes, once
Calendar entries for tax and review dates	Enter the recurring dates from the tax calendar and the review calendar once, with annual recurrence	Twenty minutes, once
A spreadsheet that pulls NAVs	Most spreadsheet tools can import a delimited file from a URL and refresh on open — the same AMFI file, no Python	Thirty minutes
Automatic monthly download of your CAS	Registrars offer scheduled mailback of consolidated statements to your registered email by PAN	Ten minutes, once
A plain-text decision log in a file you back up	No tooling. A text file and a habit.	Three minutes a week

Frequently Asked Questions

Questions that recur from Indian investors trying to build an information system. These are general explanations, not recommendations, and no source mentioned is endorsed.

> **What is the single most useful free source, if I only use one?**
>
> The exchange corporate announcements page for any company you hold, at nseindia.com or bseindia.com. Everything you read in a news article about a listed company originated there, hours earlier, in more detail and without interpretation. If you hold only index funds and have no direct equity, the equivalent answer is amfiindia.com for NAVs and category flow data, plus your registrar's consolidated statement.

> **Is Screener.in enough, or do I need a paid tool?**
>
> For a part-time investor with a capped direct-equity sleeve, a good free screener plus the exchange filings covers almost everything. Paid tools buy you convenience — aggregated estimates, segment-level operating data, pre-built alerts — not better judgement. The honest test: write down the specific decision the subscription would change. If you cannot name one, the subscription is buying the feeling of being well-equipped. **Note also that several tools are affiliated with brokers and platforms, which is a commercial relationship worth knowing about. Nothing here endorses any of them.**

How do I know if a YouTube channel or newsletter is trustworthy?

Run the conflict-of-interest questions: how do they make money; are they SEBI-registered and as what; do they disclose positions and affiliate relationships; is their archive complete and uncurated; do they revisit failed calls with the same prominence as successes; do they ever say "I do not know". Then check the registration claim in SEBI's intermediary database at sebi.gov.in, and search the name in SEBI's orders and caution notices. **Four minutes. Do it before you take a single idea from anyone.**

Someone in a Telegram group gave a tip that worked. Should I keep following them?

No, and the fact that it worked is not evidence. In any group of a thousand people making calls, some will be right by chance, and you only see the ones being promoted. The structural questions are unanswered: are they registered; do they hold the security; who is selling to you as the price rises; what is their record including losses; and why are they giving this away free rather than acting on it themselves. **One profitable tip followed by a position size that reflects new-found confidence is the standard path to a large loss.** Run the four-minute due diligence routine and note how often it terminates at step 1.

How much time should I actually spend on this each week?

Fifteen minutes a day and an hour a week is ample for a diversified portfolio of index funds, debt and gold — roughly 100 hours a year against a portfolio needing perhaps two to seven decisions. If you run a capped direct-equity sleeve, add about three hours a quarter for results and transcripts, and half a day a year for annual reports. **More time spent does not correlate with better outcomes beyond that point**, and past a certain level it correlates negatively, because additional inputs produce additional trades.

Should I watch business television?

For scheduled events — the Union Budget, an RBI policy announcement, a major result — it is a reasonable way to follow live developments. As a daily habit it is the worst available format for an investor: continuous commentary on price movement, guests whose positions are often undisclosed, a format requiring a confident view on everything within thirty seconds, and an explicit commercial objective of keeping you watching. **None of that is a criticism of the people involved; it is a description of the incentive structure.**

Where do I find earnings call transcripts?

The company's own investor relations page is the primary location, and transcripts are also commonly filed with the exchanges under corporate announcements. Several data platforms aggregate them, which is more convenient. **Verify the current disclosure requirement for recordings and transcripts under the SEBI LODR Regulations at sebi.gov.in.** They are the highest-value free document on a listed company — the only place management answers questions they did not choose.

Do FII and DII flow numbers predict the market?

There is no reliable evidence that daily institutional flow data gives a retail investor an actionable edge. The numbers describe what already happened, are as much a result of price as a cause, cover only part of foreign activity, and report cash and derivative activity separately. They are reported daily because they are available daily and sound specific, not because they forecast anything. For a long-horizon investor following a policy allocation, **daily flow data has no legitimate use**.

What is SPIVA and why does it matter more than star ratings?

The SPIVA India scorecard, published at spglobal.com/spdji, reports what percentage of actively managed funds in each category underperformed their benchmark over 1, 3, 5 and 10 years, corrected for funds that were merged or closed. A star rating tells you which funds did well in the past, which is weakly predictive. SPIVA tells you a structural fact about the category, which is the right input to the **active versus passive** decision — a decision that comes before any fund selection. **Read the current scorecard with its methodology rather than any summary; results vary by category and period, and summaries cherry-pick in both directions.**

How do I verify that someone is actually SEBI-registered?

Go to sebi.gov.in, find the intermediaries section, and search the **exact registered entity name** — not the brand name used in marketing, which is often different. Match the name, the registration number and the **category**. The category matters: a **research analyst** registration does not permit personalised investment advice; an **investment adviser** registration does; a mutual fund **distributor** (AMFI ARN) is neither. Then search the name in SEBI's enforcement orders and caution notices. If any of this fails, there is no investor protection fund, no SCORES route and no arbitration available to you.

Can I just use ChatGPT or another AI tool for market research?

For explaining concepts, summarising a document you supply, and writing analysis code — yes, usefully. For **facts about a specific company, a current price, a tax rate, a regulation or a recent event** — no. Language models produce confident, plausible, and sometimes entirely fabricated specifics, including invented figures and citations, and their knowledge has a cutoff. Any factual claim must be traced to a primary source before you act on it, which is the same rule that applies to every level-4-to-6 source in the hierarchy. **And no AI tool is a SEBI-registered investment adviser.**

How do I spot a pump-and-dump before I am in it?

Five signatures together: a small, illiquid company with a low free float; a sharp price rise on volume far above its own recent average, often with repeated upper circuits; **no exchange filing that explains the move**; coordinated messaging across channels with a specific target price and urgency; and presence on an exchange surveillance measure list. Check the surveillance list and the filings before anything else — it takes two minutes. The reason this matters more than an ordinary bad investment is liquidity: on the way down there is no buyer, successive lower circuits execute no trades, and the first price at which you can actually exit is frequently 70–90% below where you bought.

What is worth paying for?

In rough order of defensibility: a one-off engagement with a **fee-only SEBI-registered investment adviser** to sanity-check your plan; a **chartered accountant** if you have derivatives activity, foreign assets, business income or a loss to carry forward — the fee is small against a forfeited carry-forward; one data tool if it genuinely changes a decision you can name; and one subscription publication whose beat matches your holdings. Not worth paying for: tips, "calls", signal services, courses promising a system, anything with a guaranteed return, and anything requiring your trading credentials.

I feel like I am always behind on market news. Is that a problem?

No — it is the correct state. The volume of market content is unbounded and designed to be unfinishable, so "caught up" is not an achievable condition and chasing it is a treadmill. The relevant question is not whether you have read everything, but whether you have read the small number of things that touch an actual decision: the filings for what you hold, your allocation drift, and anything that changes the rules. **A deliberately small information diet is not a compromise; it is the design.**

My portfolio is entirely index funds. Do I need any of this?

Much less of it, which is one of the underrated advantages of indexing. You need: the AMFI NAV source and your registrar's statements; the amfiindia.com category flow data as an occasional temperature check; the SPIVA scorecard annually to confirm the decision still holds; the index methodology document for what you actually own; the regulators for rule changes; and the tax calendar. That is five or six sources and perhaps thirty hours a year. Everything else in this guide becomes optional reading rather than a routine.

The Bookmark Starter Pack and Weekly Routine

Everything above condenses into one bookmark folder and one recurring hour. URLs are as at early 2026 — **verify them, and note that site structures change**. Where a specific path may have moved, the domain root is given with a description of the navigation.

The bookmark starter pack

Source	URL	What it is for	How often
NSE	nseindia.com	Corporate announcements and filings, shareholding patterns, insider and bulk/block deals, index constituents and methodology, surveillance measure lists, bhavcopy downloads, circulars. Navigate via the Companies/Corporates and Market Data sections; search by company or symbol.	On any news about a holding; quarterly otherwise
BSE	bseindia.com	The same filing set, with historically stronger coverage of smaller listed companies. Cross-check here if a filing is not visible on the other exchange.	As needed
SEBI	sebi.gov.in	Regulations and master circulars, **enforcement orders**, consultation papers, the **intermediary verification database**, caution notices, investor education material, research studies, and SCORES. Navigate via Legal, Enforcement, Intermediaries and Reports sections.	Before paying any intermediary; quarterly for regulation changes
RBI	rbi.org.in	Monetary policy statements and minutes, the monthly Bulletin, the Database on the Indian Economy, Financial Stability Report, FEMA and	Monthly; policy dates in your calendar

		LRS master directions, unclaimed deposits search. Navigate via Publications, Statistics and Notifications.	
AMFI	amfiindia.com	Daily NAV file, monthly category AUM and flows, SIP totals, scheme categorisation, ARN distributor search	Monthly
MF Central	mfcentral.com	A single view of your own mutual fund holdings across both registrars, plus service requests — nomination, KYC, statements	Half-yearly, and whenever details change
CAMS	camsonline.com	Consolidated account statements and, critically, **capital gains statements** for schemes it services. Pair with the other registrar for full coverage.	Each April, before tax filing
Screener.in	screener.in	Fundamental screening and standardised ten-year financials with links back to filings. A shortlisting tool, never a decision tool.	Only when researching a direct holding
Value Research	valueresearchonline.com	Fund data, category comparison, portfolio overlap, rolling returns. Use the data; treat the ratings as an opinion.	Annually, at the fund review
SPIVA India scorecard	spglobal.com/spdji	Survivorship-corrected evidence on active versus passive by category. Read with the methodology.	Annually
TradingView	tradingview.com	Long-run price history, normalised comparison between instruments,	Only before a transaction

		premium/discount and liquidity checks before dealing. Free tier has limits; real-time Indian data typically needs a paid subscription.	
Moneycontrol	moneycontrol.com	Filings aggregation, results coverage, data pages, a large archive. Ignore the recommendation-style content entirely.	As a data destination, as needed
Mint	livemint.com	Markets coverage, data journalism, policy. One business daily is enough — pick one of these three.	Daily, 15 minutes
Business Standard	business-standard.com	Policy, corporate governance and sectoral analysis	Daily, 15 minutes
Hindu BusinessLine	thehindubusinessline.com	Commodities, agriculture, banking	Daily, 15 minutes
Economic Times	economictimes.indiatimes.com	Breadth of corporate news. Discount the stock-specific "may give X%" genre entirely.	As needed
Reuters	reuters.com	Wire-standard verification that a story is real; global context	When verifying a widely circulated claim
Financial Times	ft.com	Global macro and cross-border context if you hold international exposure. Paywalled.	Weekly, optional
Bloomberg	bloomberg.com	Global markets and macro. Much of the best content is paywalled or terminal-only.	Optional
Zerodha Varsity	zerodha.com/varsity	Structured free education across market basics,	Once, properly; revisit modules

		analysis, derivatives, risk and taxation. Note the publisher is a broker.	as needed
NISM	nism.ac.in	Certification syllabi and workbooks — a structured curriculum even if you never sit the exam	Once, if you want depth
MCA	mca.gov.in	Company master data, director search, filed documents for unlisted companies, IEPF unclaimed assets	When checking an entity or searching for unclaimed assets
Income Tax e-filing	incometax.gov.in	AIS, TIS, Form 26AS, return filing, e-Pay Tax for advance tax. See the tax guide.	Quarterly for advance tax; June–July for filing
Depositories	cdslindia.com, nsdl.co.in	Consolidated account statements by PAN, FPI data, nomination and KYC services	Half-yearly
MoSPI	mospi.gov.in	CPI, GDP, IIP releases — read the release, not the headline	Monthly, optional

⚠ **Verify every URL and every description**
Site structures, section names, free-tier limits and subscription prices all change, and some of the paths implied above may have moved. **Where a link does not resolve, go to the domain root and navigate from the top-level sections.** Nothing in this table is a recommendation of any platform, publication or service; each is described so you can evaluate it against the conflict-of-interest questions earlier in this guide.

The weekly research routine template

TEXT

```
WEEKLY RESEARCH SESSION
Week ending: _____________   Time started: ______
TIMEBOX: 60 MINUTES. Set a timer.

_____________________________________________

PART 1 - MAINTENANCE (15 minutes)

 [ ] All standing instructions executed this week?
     If any failed, fix it now.
 [ ] Transactions entered in the tracker,
     INCLUDING all charges
 [ ] Current values updated
 [ ] Any corporate action affecting cost basis?
       bonus / split / rights / demerger / dividend
       If yes, record the ratio AND the source
       filing reference. Do not leave this.

_____________________________________________

PART 2 - ONE NUMBER (2 minutes)

 10-year G-Sec yield            _______ %
 Change vs last week            _______ pp
 (Monthly only: the full six-line macro
  dashboard)

_____________________________________________

PART 3 - ONE LONG-FORM READ (30 minutes)

 What I read:
   ____________________________________
 Source level (1-6 on the hierarchy): ____
 If level 4-6, did I trace the key claim back
 to a primary source?           yes / no

 THREE SENTENCES
 1. What I learned:
    ____________________________________
 2. What I am still uncertain about:
    ____________________________________
 3. What, if anything, this changes:
    ____________________________________
    (The honest answer is almost always
     "nothing". Write it anyway.)

_____________________________________________

PART 4 - WATCHLIST HYGIENE (5 minutes)

 [ ] Anything in Tier 2 (Studying) with no
```

```
     progress in two quarters?  → remove it
 [ ] Anything I added this week purely because
     it had risen?              → remove it
 [ ] Tier 1 + Tier 2 total:     ______ names
     (hard cap: under 20)

_____________________________________________

PART 5 - SOURCE AUDIT (3 minutes)

 Did I consume anything this week that:
 [ ] arrived via a push notification?
     → turn that notification off now
 [ ] came from a group or channel giving
     specific security recommendations?
     → leave the group
 [ ] made me want to transact without a
     pre-written rule?
     → note it in the decision log; take no
        action for 30 days

_____________________________________________

PART 6 - ACTION

 [ ] No action required  (the default, and the
     correct answer in most weeks)
 [ ] Rebalancing band breached - see the
     portfolio construction guide, inflows first
 [ ] A written thesis condition triggered -
     follow the thesis note
 [ ] A tax date approaching - see the tax guide
     calendar

 NOTHING ELSE CONSTITUTES A REASON TO ACT.

Time finished: ______
If this took more than 60 minutes, the problem
is the source list, not the schedule.
```

10	0	3	4 min
SOURCES, TOTAL	PUSH NOTIFICATIONS	FILES TO MAINTAIN	DUE DILIGENCE ROUTINE

The twelve rules, condensed

1 **Know the level of every claim**

Primary filing, regulator, curated data, analyst, news, social. Never act on levels 4 to 6 without tracing to 1 or 2.

2 **Go to the filing**

Everything you read about a listed company originated there, earlier and in more detail.

3 **Verify registration before paying anyone**

Four minutes on the SEBI intermediary database. Match name, number and category.

4 **Prefer boring sources**

Regulatory filings and statistical releases are reliable precisely because they are not competing for your attention.

5 **Ask how each source is paid**

And whether that method depends on you transacting.

6 **No alert without a pre-written action**

If you cannot complete "when this fires I will do X", the alert should not exist.

7 **Turn off every push notification**

There is no market event that needs to interrupt you.

8 **Keep the diet small on purpose**

Ten sources, a fixed schedule, and a willingness to be permanently behind.

9 **Write three sentences a week**

Reading without recording produces the impression of knowledge and none of the benefit.

10 **Separate reviewing from acting**

Different sessions, different days. A review that can end in a trade becomes a justification exercise.

11 **Assume a screenshot is fabricated**

And assume an accuracy percentage is meaningless. Ask for a full-year statement including losses, and note the refusal.

12 **Default to no action**

A portfolio built on the principles in the portfolio construction guide needs between zero and seven decisions a year. Everything else you read is, for your purposes, noise — and noise that provokes a trade is worse than noise you ignored.

✓ **Where to go next**

For the portfolio this information system exists to serve, see building and managing a portfolio. For what every transaction costs and what the regulator's protections actually cover, see taxation and regulation for Indian investors. For what to do with a company's filings once you have them, see stock analysis. For funds, see mutual funds and SIPs. For the market plumbing behind the filings, see how the Indian stock market works. For the honest evidence on trading, see derivatives and options and trading strategy and risk. And before all of them, investing foundations.

✗ **Closing reminder**

This guide is **financial education, not financial advice**. No security, scheme, fund, broker, platform, publication, newsletter, channel or adviser is recommended anywhere in it; descriptions are provided so you can evaluate sources yourself, and **no source listed has been tested for accuracy by this guide**. **Past performance does not predict future returns. Capital is at risk.** URLs, features, free-tier limits and pricing are stated as at **early 2026** and change — verify before relying on anything. Regulatory and tax statements are stated as at **FY 2025-26 / AY 2026-27** and must be checked at **sebi.gov.in**, **rbi.org.in** and **incometax.gov.in**; note in particular that the **Income-tax Act 2025 replaces the 1961 Act from 1 April 2026 with sections renumbered throughout — verify current status**. For advice on your own circumstances, consult a **SEBI-registered Investment Adviser** whose registration you have verified, and have a **chartered accountant** review your actual tax return.